# Spells and Daggers

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/40236426.

**Rating:**
Teen And Up Audiences

**Archive Warning:**
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

**Categories:**
F/F, F/M, Gen, Multi, Other

**Fandom:**
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

**Relationships:**
Adora/Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow/Perfuma (She-Ra)

**Characters:**
Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

**Additional Tags:**
Supernatural (not the show), Glimadora - Freeform, Glimmadora - Freeform, Background Relationships, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Mystical Creatures, Supernatural Elements, Alternate Universe - Supernatural Elements, Light Swearing, Magic, Modern AU, all characters in 20s or older, Hunters & Hunting, Trauma, Hurt/Comfort, Angst, Romance, Girls in Love, Girlfriends - Freeform, Eventual Romance, bowfuma, Dreams and Nightmares, Glimmer Swears (She-Ra), let Glimmer say fuck, slayer au, loosely inspired by buffy, and other supernatural dramas, Long Live Feedback Comment Project

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# Spells and Daggers

by ThatADORAbleWarriorLady

Summary

Adora is a hunter. She protects people from supernatural monsters.

Glimmer is a witch who comes from a lineage of powerful spellcasters.

Once their paths meet, they may work together to bring down the Horde clan.

# Chapter 1

Chapter Notes

This story is part of the LLF Comment Project, which was created to improve communication between readers and authors. This author invites and appreciates feedback, including:

Feedback

- Short comments
- Long comments
- Questions
- Constructive criticism
- "<3" as extra kudos
- Reader-reader interaction

The author may not respond due to real life taking up time, but will appreciate comments.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The first rays of dawn spilled into the sky as Adora jogged across the sidewalk. Sweat raced down her forehead, and a few blonde strands clung to her neck. Dogs barked at her as she passed by. Eventually, she arrived at her house and stepped through the door. Closing the door behind her, she strode to the kitchen and brewed a cup of coffee. She leaned against the island counter, gazing at the cardboard boxes by the sofa. There were still items to unpack. A month ago, she had moved to Bright Moon City.

Adora's phone rang, interrupting her thoughts as she poured the steaming coffee into a mug. She picked up the phone. The screen displayed Catra's picture. *Not her again.* After she pressed the "decline" button, she blocked Catra's number. The memory of Catra's beastly side arose. Her scars burned, as though Catra's claws had just penetrated her flesh.

Adora and Catra had befriended each other during their elementary school years. Upon learning that they both had unhappy childhoods, they bonded. While Adora was raised by Shadow Weaver, Catra grew up in an orphanage. No one wanted to adopt Catra. When they were in tenth grade, they started dating. At the time, Adora didn't know that Catra escaped the orphanage and hung out with the wrong crowd. Their relationship took a turn for the worse after graduation. Catra would manipulate her, strike her, and even joke about dating girls behind her back. Whenever Adora said something the brunette didn't like, Catra would become furious and shout obscenities.

The first few times Adora had tried to leave, Catra had threatened her. One day, she had decided that enough was enough and chose to move out. In a fit of rage, Catra transformed into a werepanther and lashed out at her. Adora had fled their apartment as soon as possible. The phone chimed, displaying a social media notification. The profile that contacted her contained a picture of Catra. Her ex must have made a new account just to message her. Would this girl ever leave her alone? Releasing a sigh, she began texting.

**9:15**
**Adora:** You need to back off. We're over.

**Catra:** If you don't come home, I'll track you down. Where do you live?

**9:16**
**Adora:** I'm not revealing my location.

Adora blocked Catra's new social media account and deleted the messages. She lifted the mug to her lips, then sipped the coffee. Any moment now, she could receive a report of a hidden supernatural group, or a dark creature attacking the humans. After she placed the mug into the sink, she strode to her room and changed her clothes. She wore a red sleeveless vest with a white t-shirt underneath. Gray jeans emphasized her toned legs. The mirror above the dresser caught her attention. A blonde

woman stared back at her. The left side of her face bore small scars. Her mind flashed to the fight and the break-up. Shoving the painful memories aside, she made her way to the front door and exited the house.

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Adora stormed into a hideout upon receiving information about several vampires lurking here. She explored each room and navigated the hallways before finding a basement. A group of vampires turned to face her. They were shrivelled up, and they bore sharp teeth. She rose her gun and fired silver bullets into each vampire. Once she was done, she heard voices drifting from the door. She followed the sound to a storage room. A tanned, stocky woman tossed a potion at a demon. During her short career as a hunter, Adora hadn't seen a witch confront a foul creature. The vial shattered, spilling its liquid onto the ground. Smoke enveloped the demon as the woman shouted an incantation. After the demon vanished, the woman turned her attention to Adora, violet eyes peering into her bright blues.

She seemed to be around Adora's age. The left side of her head was buzzed, while her dyed purple and pink locks stopped just above her jawline. She wore a purple shirt underneath her unzipped periwinkle vest, along with denim jeans and black boots. Piercings dotted her ears. A pair of fingerless gloves finished the look.

"I thought supernaturals don't hunt dark creatures," Adora said as she pocketed her gun.

"Some of us do," the woman replied.

"Have you always been a witch?"

"Yes, but my magic had been dormant. I unlocked my powers not too long ago, by reading a page aloud in a spellbook."

Adora arched her brows. "Have you ever used your powers to hurt anyone?"

"No. I only use magic to protect the innocent. Anyways, call me Glimmer."

"I'm Adora."

"Adora? What a cute name."

"Um... thanks? I like your name, too." Adora made her way to the door. "While you were fighting a demon, I vanquished multiple vampires."

Glimmer began following Adora. "Are you a hunter?"

"Yes," Adora replied. "Ever since I moved to Bright Moon City."

The two women walked through the hallway. Adora scanned her surroundings, remaining alert. It didn't take long for them to reach the exit. They stepped outside, then strode to the parking lot. Bright Moon City was busy today. Tons of cars crowded the streets. People hurried down the sidewalk, and small children skipped over narrow lines on the pavement. A discordant combination of honking cars, loud voices, and screeching tires drilled into her ears. The wind blew through the city.

"I'd like to know you better," Glimmer said as the women approached their respective cars. She took out a phone and handed it to Adora. "Can we meet again? Perhaps at the Thaymor Diner?"

Adora shrugged. "I guess." She grabbed the phone and pulled out her own. Then, she typed in the number. "Are you asking me out?"

Glimmer retrieved her phone. "Of course. Well, not exactly." Her cheeks reddened. "We just met. And you're cute, so..."

"When are we going to meet up at the diner?"

"Around five. Are you free tonight?"

"I think so." Adora checked a schedule on her phone. "I have to be sure. Something unexpected could show up." She opened the car door and scooted into the driver's seat.

Once Adora was inside the car, she steered the vehicle onto the street. Her mind replayed the conversation. She wasn't interested in romance at the moment. Last time she dated someone, it didn't go well. A part of her wondered if she would ever fall in love with the right woman. She pressed a button on the radio. The first thing she heard was a news report. Then, she changed the station. Like the previous radio channel, this one didn't have interesting music. She skipped the rest of the channels until she found one with music.

---

Afternoon came. Glimmer entered the manor, ascended the stairs to her bedroom, and approached her large closet. If it had more room, it would be a walk-in closet instead. She turned on the lights and scrutinized her clothes. Her fingers brushed a sleeveless dress. She might not be going to a formal event, but she wanted to look nice. The alternative was a pastel purple blouse, a matching choker, a black skirt with white moons on its ruffles, fishnet stockings, and platform boots.

Glimmer chose the alternative, so she slipped into that outfit and walked to the vanity. A picture frame garnered her attention. In the photo, she was standing between her parents as they posed for the camera. Angella had long, colored hair, while Micah's graying hair reached his shoulders. A frown tugged at her lips as she blinked back a few tears.

Glimmer's parents were powerful spellcasters, but that wasn't enough to prevent their deaths. She had been at university when they lost their lives, and when Bow told her the news, she returned home. The couple had died in a fatal car crash, and after their bodies were recovered, a small funeral took place. One night, their spirits had visited her. Angella had told her to unlock her powers. At first, she was reluctant, because it would be like admitting that her parents were gone. Curiosity had suppressed

her reluctance, and upon verbally reading a spell, she had awakened her magic.

Inhaling deeply, Glimmer began putting on makeup. Her thoughts drifted to Adora. She couldn't forget the way the shirt, vest, and jeans emphasized the blonde's physique. *Great. I have it bad.* She spritzed perfume onto her body and left the room. Pictures of the Fukuda family dotted the wall above the mahogany stairs. Her family had owned the Fukuda manor for several generations. Magic was a part of their bloodline. They had been protectors of Bright Moon City, defending humans from the Horde clan.

The Horde clan's goal was to dominate the human race and crush the Rebellion clan. They had another goal - to unleash more demons from the Underworld. As determined as any hunter would be to vanquish dark creatures, they might not be strong enough to defeat the more brutal monsters.

Glimmer descended the stairs, stepped outside, and rushed to her car. She couldn't wait to see Adora again, and she didn't want to be late. *It's not even a date, and you're worried about punctuality.* She entered the car and backed out of the driveway. This neighborhood was one of the older districts in Bright Moon City, with Victorian structures and antique cars lining some driveways. Steering the car down the road, she drove the vehicle toward the main street.

A red light hindered Glimmer. Her fingers tapped the wheel as she observed the traffic. *Perks of living in big cities, right?* Dozens of vehicles sped back and forth. She didn't have patience for traffic. Swearing under her breath, she glanced at the time on the radio. Then, she turned her attention back to the street in front of her. The light flashed green, and she drove past the skyscrapers.

Time dragged on as Glimmer stopped at a few more red lights. The traffic hadn't gone away. *Of course. It's Friday afternoon.* She could have chosen any other day, but when she had been talking to Adora, she forgot what day it was. All because her mind was on asking Adora out. The blonde was too cute to ignore. As soon as

the traffic faded, she moved her car into a plaza. Stores and restaurants surrounded a central parking area. She parked her car by the Thaymor Diner, then exited the vehicle.

The summer heat blanketed the city as Glimmer hurried toward the diner. Her fingers enveloped the handle, and upon pulling the door open, a blast of cold air met her body. Once she was inside the restaurant, her gaze scanned the busy tables. Adora sat by the window, waving at her. Glimmer proceeded past the tables and took a seat across from Adora.

Adora wore a red shirt, tucked behind an unbuttoned white blazer with golden accents. The neckline was low enough to allow for a subtle peek at her chest. A pair of matching pants stopped just above her ankles. Those colors looked perfect on her. She picked up the menu and began scrutinizing the options.

"Can we, um, order something first?" Adora asked.

"Sure. On the way here, I ran into traffic, and I thought it would take forever," Glimmer replied.

The two women ordered some food. By the time their meals arrived, they decided to continue the conversation. While Adora wolfed down her grilled cheese sandwich, Glimmer nibbled on a burger and sipped a glass of strawberry milkshake. Occassionally, Adora would dunk a fry into the chocolate shake and eat it.

"What is it like?" Glimmer asked, and Adora looked up.

"What are you talking about?" Adora replied.

"Being a hunter. Also... why did you want to become one?"

"I hadn't wanted to become a hunter. A mysterious woman, Hope Light, came to me one day when I visited the library. She suggested the idea of fighting vampires and demons. Hope told me that she had a vision of me slaying monsters."

"So, that's how you got the job." Glimmer dipped a long spoon into her tall glass and scooped the leftover milkshake. "Speaking of jobs... when I'm not fighting monsters, I work at the flower shop. One of my friends, Perfuma, also works there. She's a fairy."

Adora nodded. "So, do you have any other supernatural friends?"

"Yes. Her name's Mermista. She and Perfuma are both dating humans."

"Do their partners know?"

"They do. Anyways... tell me about yourself. What was your life like before you moved?"

"When I was five, my adoptive mother took me in. She was a cruel and manipulative woman. After I graduated from high school, I started living with my abusive ex-girlfriend. Last month, we broke up, and it made her furious." Adora winced, as though remembering a traumatic event. "I escaped the apartment and drove all the way to this city. Mind if we discuss something else?"

"It's okay if you don't want to talk about your trauma. You deserve to be treated with kindness."

Adora nodded. "it's a story for another time. So... tell me about yourself."

"I'm from a family of powerful witches. We're protectors of this city," Glimmer said. "After my parents died, I inherited the Fukuda manor. My aunt was an only living relative, but she stayed in Mystacor, a nearby town."

Adora cleared her throat. "It has been nice to talk to you." She stood. "If you'll excuse me, I've got boxes to unpack in my house."

Glimmer smiled. "I'd like to see you again." She rose to her height. "And, Adora?"

"What is it?"

"I enjoyed our chat."

Chapter End Notes

Like with some of my other multi-chapter fics, the chapters will vary in length. I got some inspiration from watching supernatural dramas, so there might be some possible similarities in this fic. If you want to read more Glimmadora fics, you can check out my other stories.

Here's a list of writers I recommend:

Athetos
catsaretriangles
CuriousScientistKae
Hanzade
EtherianFrigatebird
CountDorku
TheShortestManOnEarth
TeamGlimmadora
TheOriginalCowboyCat
LadyLazuli97
SwordsandBones
NamakiTDR
watertribesato

Anyways, I hope you enjoy the story!

# Chapter 2

Once Adora was home, she unpacked the rest of her belongings and put them away. By the time she was done, she showered, then changed into her pajamas. Now it was nine at night. She plopped onto her bed, turned off the lights, and reclined. Outdoor lights peeked through the blinds. A distant hum of a vehicle leaked into her ears as she scrutinized the ceiling. She might not mind befriending Glimmer, but when it came to romance, she didn't want to deal with another Catra. The pink-haired woman was nice, though. So was her ex, at first, before things took a turn for the worse. Heaviness weighed upon her limbs as she closed her eyes. As she drifted to dreamland, an image surfaced. At first, it was blurry. Eventually, it became clear.

...

*Adora was walking toward a living room in her apartment. It was always a mess - empty alcohol bottles, unwashed plates, cigarettes strewn across one side of the coffee table, and an open pizza box with half-eaten slices. The entire apartment was poorly lit, with impenetrable blackness lurking in the doorways. One of the doors creaked, revealing Catra. The brunette wore ripped jeans, a leather jacket, and a black t-shirt. Catra's mismatched eyes bore into hers, and the woman wore a deep scowl. A chill settled in the air as Catra approached. She attempted to step back, but she was frozen to the spot. Darkness cloaked Catra's left side.*

*"You abandoned me," Catra said. "It's all your fault." She bared her fangs, and a growl erupted from her lips.*

*Adora blinked, and the next thing she knew, a large tan werepanther stood on its hind legs. Catra swiped a paw at her. The scenery flashed to her old bedroom. Where did Catra go? She caught a glimpse of her teenage self in the mirror. She wore a red varsity jacket and gray shorts. Did she get younger? The door*

*swung open, and she whirled around. A pale woman with ebony hair and green eyes shut the door, glaring at her.*

*Shadows sprung from the corners of the room. The woman reached out a hand and touched Adora's cheek. She opened her mouth to say something, but no sound came out. Anger darkened her adoptive mother's eyes. What did she do this time? Wander off in the middle of the night?*

*"That girl is a bad influence on you. She'll drag you down. Instead of defying me, you should be grateful. I took you in when your parents died." Shadow Weaver leaned closer, her face inches away from Adora's ear. "I could have left you in the orphanage."*

*Another scene arose. The distant screams had drawn a much younger Adora to the entryway. Pools of blood surrounded a pair of bodies. A little boy raced to the door and exited the house. She turned her attention to the comatose bodies. Distant sirens wailed, and as she descended the stairs, a woman in uniform approached her. Other visitors said something about finding the person who murdered the couple.*

*Suddenly, Adora was in an orphanage. She found the little boy again. It didn't take long for a raven-haired woman to adopt her. The woman grabbed her hand and led her outside, escorting her across a parking lot.*

*"Why can't Adam come?" Adora asked.*

*"You'll be fine without him. Get in the car." The woman forced Adora into the backseat. "I'm your mother now."*

*Darkness flooded Adora's vision. More and more memories sprung from her subconscious, taunting her. She began falling into a bottomless chasm, a scream lodged into her throat as she tried, but failed, to break her fall. An invisible noose tightened around her neck, and her pulse thudded.*

...

Adora jolted awake, screaming. Darkness surrounded her, and her eyes adjusted to the blackness. Her brain took longer to catch up. She was in her room. Her current house. Fragments of the nightmare lingered, and sweat drenched her hairline. Taking in deep breaths, she waited for her heartbeat to slow down. Something bumped against the window, triggering a fight or flight response. Sleep wouldn't return to her anytime soon, so why wait? She swung her legs over the edge of the bed, slipped on her shoes and jacket, and strode outside. Stars twinkled in the inky blackness. From time to time, the occasional car would whiz by.

A cloaked silhouette materialized under a streetlamp. Adora stepped into her house and retrieved a dagger from a nearby drawer. By the time she returned outside, the mysterious visitor was already gone. Where did it go? Unsatisfied with its sudden absence, she advanced. Making her way across the lawn, she scrutinized the area. She sensed someone watching her. The hairs on her neck stood, and she peeked behind her. Was someone following her, or was she imagining things due to having nightmares?

"Adora..." A disembodied voice spoke. The voice sounded familiar.

Adora whirled around, tightening her grip on the dagger. She had two options; continue searching for the intruder, or go inside the house and brush it off as a hallucination. The former made more sense to her. Releasing a breath she didn't realize she was holding, she snuck into the backyard. The same voice from before repeated her name. As far as she knew, her home wasn't haunted. Neither was the neighborhood. There was no cemetery nearby.

"Whoever you are... show yourself," Adora whispered.

The wind howled. Adora's dagger gleamed in the moonlight as she pointed the weapon at an empty space. A part of her expected the silhouette to emerge. Yet it didn't. Maybe the visitor fled. She hurried into the house and locked the doors. Then, she checked the windows and the rooms. So far, everything was

untouched. Upon entering her bedroom, she removed her jacket and shoes. The nightmare might have caused her to feel tense. If she didn't possess any trauma, she wouldn't be suffering from those dreams. She placed the dagger onto her nightstand, reclined on her bed, and forced herself to relax.

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It was ten in the morning when Glimmer drove to the cafe. Her job would start in thirty minutes, and she wanted to grab some coffee and a breakfast pastry. She entered the cafe, and the sight of a familiar blonde greeted her. Adora rested her elbows on the table, occasionally closing her eyes. Glimmer ordered an iced coffee and a cinnamon roll, then strode to Adora's table. The blonde looked up. Dark circles sat under tired blue eyes. Did the taller woman get any sleep?

"How are you?" Glimmer asked.

Adora yawned. "Fine."

"You seem tired."

"I'll be fine."

Glimmer stuck her fork into the cinnamon roll. "Adora... I'm interested in befriending you. There's no need to keep your walls up."

Adora sighed as she crossed her arms. "You want to know why I'm tired? I had a nightmare, so I went outside. A cloaked stranger appeared under a streetlamp when I went outside in the middle of the night. Thinking it was a demon, I grabbed a dagger and prepared to confront them. By then, they were already gone. I swore someone had been watching me as I checked the front yard and the backyard. A spooky voice, possibly belonging to them, said my name."

"What was the nightmare about?"

"First, my ex. Second, my adoptive mother. Also, a small snippet of a dead couple and a little boy. The day Shadow Weaver adopted me. "

"Shadow Weaver? I remember my father mentioning that he used to learn magic from her during his teen years."

Adora arched her brows. "She mentored your father?"

"For a bit. Until she used a forbidden spell that corrupted her." Glimmer sipped her coffee. "So, whoever the cloaked person is, do you think it could be her astral projection or some sort of spy?"

"It could be. I think I angered her by moving out after graduating from high school and cutting off all contact with her."

"Have you known the couple and the little boy?"

Adora shrugged. "I don't recognize them. Maybe it's a suppressed memory." The screen on her phone flashed to life, revealing a text. "Excuse me while I check a message." She tapped the screen, then pushed the phone into her bag. "A clan of vampires has been hiding in the catacombs."

Glimmer glanced at her watch. "I better get to work. See you later."

Once Adora left the cafe, Glimmer walked to her car and drove to the flower shop. A part of her wanted to go help Adora, but she would risk losing her job as a result of not being at work. Would it matter, though? She was the current protector of this city. If she let the Horde clan crush the Rebellion, and if she allowed their enemies to release demons from the Underworld, Bright Moon City would suffer. She stepped into the flower shop.

Floral scents wafted into Glimmer's nose as she stepped behind the counter. Flowers of all colors and sizes decorated the vases, waiting to be picked. Small boxes of chocolate idled on the counter. Perfuma had just finished creating a floral arrangement.

The fairy was a tall, slender woman, with platinum blonde hair, tan skin, and freckles.

"Perfuma, you're in a relationship, right?" Glimmer asked.

"Yes. Why?" Perfuma asked as she turned to face the shorter woman. "Is there someone you like?"

"There is. I met her yesterday, and ran into her again this morning. Adora is cute. So... what was it like to go from crushes to lovers?"

Perfuma smiled as she carried the arrangement to a shelf. "Bow and I were nervous around each other at first. One day, he offered to take me out for dinner, and I accepted. As far as I know, two people in a relationship learn about each other, and they start opening up. We had those deep conversations, and if we ever had a disagreement, we'd be quick to make amends. You know it's the right person if you can't imagine life without them."

"Yeah, but how do you know if your crush likes you?"

"They'll show interest. Sometimes they may compliment you. Bonus points if they ask you out."

"Adora did compliment me. Said that she liked my name. I showed interest and asked her out, though. We talked about ourselves."

"I think she may recioprate your feelings. Is she new to Bright Moon City, or has she always lived here?"

"She has been living in Bright Moon City for a month."

"She's new, then."

The two women spent their morning selling floral arrangements to customers. Once it was time for a break, Glimmer texted Adora, asking if the blonde slayed any vampires yet. Several minutes passed without a response. She whispered an incantation,

resulting in a vision of the catacombs. *Maybe I should go check.* She told Perfuma that she would be gone for a little bit, then left the flower shop.

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The catacombs would be the perfect setting for a horror film. Skulls in decorative arches. Mummified bodies in open coffins. Statues with soulless expressions. Adora navigated the dim passageways, keeping herself alert for the slightest noise. Water dripped from a ceiling, and footsteps followed her. She peeked over her shoulder. A voice whispered her name, prompting her to look in all directions. Either this place was haunted, or the entity she encountered in her neighborhood last night was stalking her. A hooded figure materialized in front of her. Pointing the dagger at them, she braced herself for a fight.

Cold air enveloped Adora. A pair of shadowy hands brushed her jawline. The hairs on her arms stood. *You're a hunter. You shouldn't freeze in fear.* Inhaling deeply, she narrowed her eyes and shoved the hands away from her face. The hooded figure took on a feminine form. She recognized her. *Shadow Weaver.* The woman who abused her. She clenched her fists in an attempt to quell their shaking.

"Adora, I've missed you," Shadow Weaver said.

"Aren't you in Fright Zone City?" Adora asked. "In case you're wondering, I'm not going back."

"This is my astral projection. Keep in mind that I'm the one who adopted you. No one else had the heart to do so. If you hadn't ran off with Catra, you wouldn't have suffered. I'm the only one who cares about you. Look at you now, all alone and scared. All because you're not under my protection."

"Go away. I'm here to fight vampires, not listen to your manipulative words."

Shadow Weaver grabbed Adora's wrist. "You shall not defy me!"

Adora straightened her spine, refusing to display any fear. Her younger self would have flinched upon hearing anger in the woman's voice. But she was older now, and she had no reason to return to Fright Zone City. Not even Shadow Weaver or Catra could convince her to do so. They would have to take her by force, something she wouldn't let them do.

"You know what? You're not my mother, and you don't have any control over my choices," Adora said.

Shadow Weaver hissed. "You've never listened to me. I'll bend you to my will!" She vanished into thin air.

Releasing an audible exhale, Adora navigated the rest of the catacombs. It didn't take long for her to find a room. Like the tunnels, this room had dim lighting. A group of vampires surrounded her. One of them had cropped blue hair, pale skin, and red eyes. Hadn't she seen someone with a similar hairstyle before? For a moment, she racked her brain for any memories of such a person. There was indeed one. A former principal at Fright Zone High. *Mr. Hordak, isn't it?*

"Does the name Hordak ring a bell?" Adora asked, glaring at the tall vampire.

"Yes. I'm Hordak," the vampire said.

"Why are vampires and demons targeting Bright Moon City?"

"We're here to defeat the Rebellion clan. And we're taking down any hunter that stands in our way."

"I'll tell you what." Adora smirked. "As long as I'm a hunter, you won't be seeing any progress." She lunged at the other vampires, plunging her dagger into each one. As a result, they disintegrated to piles of ashes.

Then, Adora closed the distance between herself and Hordak and swung the dagger toward him. He caught her wrist before she could finish him off. A scowl flashed across his features as he

bared his sharp teeth. She drove her knee into his groin, forcing him to release her. Hordak stared her down, muttering forbidden words under his breath.

"Once Horde Prime rises, it'll be over for those who oppose the Horde clan. The humans will be under our command," Hordak said. In a swift motion, he grabbed Adora's throat and lifted her off the ground. "Hunters, such as you, will perish." He peered past her. "Looks like we got company."

An invisible force separated Adora and Hordak, then flung the latter toward the wall. Upon landing onto her feet, she glanced at the exit. Glimmer stood in the doorway. Did the shorter woman just save her? She knew she could take care of herself, but a part of her appreciated the rescue. How did Glimmer find her, though?

"What brought you here?" Adora asked.

Glimmer closed the distance between the two women. "I had a vision, so I came here. Well, let's go."

Adora peered over her shoulder and saw that Hordak was already gone. She didn't know if he was vanquished, or if he left while she wasn't looking. Somehow, the latter made more sense. After all, she didn't see him disintegrate into ashes. Whoever Horde Prime was, did Hordak decide to report to them?

# Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

> Glimmer and Adora become friends. Another dream shows up in this chapter.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

After leaving the catacombs, Adora visited the park. She occupied a bench by the small pond, watching people walk across sidewalks. Several families sat on the grass, enjoying their picnics. A gentle breeze rippled through her hair as she played games on her phone. However, her mind wasn't on the apps. Instead, she dwelled on the moment Glimmer found her in the catacombs and saved her. There was something different about the shorter woman. Glimmer had been kind to her. So was Catra, when Adora met the brunette in elementary school. But even then, Catra hadn't liked the idea of Adora befriending other people.

A golden retriever approached Adora, and she looked up as a woman with dyed pigtails stepped forward. She held out a hand to the dog, allowing its wet, cool nose to touch her palm. The woman grabbed the dog's collar.

"Emily likes people," the woman said, smiling.

"I'm sure she does," Adora said. "However, I don't think she should be off the leash. Anyways, what's your name?"

The woman held out a hand. "I'm Entrapta."

Adora shook Entrapta's hand. "Adora."

"Nice to meet you. Well, I don't have a lot of friends, except for Emily. I guess it's because I'm neurodivergent. Also, I'm a scientist." Entrapta glanced at her watch. "Whoops. I have to go now."

Entrapta and Emily ran off in a hurry. Adora checked the texts on her phone. Since the scuffle in the catacombs, there weren't any more reports. Maybe the vampires and demons were covering up their tracks? Hope Light told her that some of them preferred to be more subtle than others. It could be the case. Those creatures would pretend to be humans, or take on the appearance of another. She possessed the ability to see past the disguises. In human form, they could be enticing and act polite. As someone once said, looks could be deceiving. So far, though, she hadn't seen any suspicious individuals anywhere.

Adora strode to the parking lot, entered her car, and began driving. Unlike yesterday, there wasn't as much traffic on the streets. Time dragged on as she made several turns. At one point, she circled a roundabout and proceeded toward a neighborhood, where she lived. Slowing down the car, she moved past the houses and reached her own. What she saw shocked her. She was hoping it was a figment of her imagination. But it wasn't. Flames emerged from the house, eating away at the roof and walls. She was sure she didn't leave anything on that might cause a fire.

What happened, then? Did a vampire or a demon do this to send Adora a message? She had just unpacked the rest of her belongings last night! Could someone from her past have done this to spite her? Either Shadow Weaver or Catra would do such a thing. Stepping out of the car, she made her way to the sidewalk. A tall woman in uniform stopped her. The woman had dark hair and a caramel complexion.

"I didn't leave anything on," Adora said.

"We haven't ruled out the cause of the fire yet," the woman replied.

"Gosh. I just moved here a month ago." Adora glanced at her house, then at the car. She took out her phone and texted Glimmer. "I'm going now. Thanks for telling me that I lost my home."

"I'm sorry about the bad news."

Adora's phone chimed, alerting her to a new message.

**2:20**
**Glimmer:** That sounds horrible. If you want, you can stay at my place. I'll give you the address.

**Adora:** I appreciate your sympathy. If I stay at your place, I think it'll be temporary until I find a new home.

**Glimmer:** Okay. Looking up the address right now. I'll send it to you in a sec.

Adora stepped into her car and sat behind the wheel. The phone pinged again, and she tapped the text containing the address. According to the map, Glimmer's place was in a different neighborhood.

---

Thirty minutes passed as Glimmer prepared a spare room for Adora's arrival. She couldn't help but wonder if the person who visited Adora last night caused the fire. It could have been Shadow Weaver's magic. Or a demon. As far as she knew regarding magic, a witch could summon a demon using a dark spell. Upon exiting the spare room, the doorbell rang. She descended the stairs and opened the door, revealing Adora.

"Hey," Glimmer said.

"I lost a lot of my stuff in the fire," Adora replied as she entered the manor. "Including my clothes."

Glimmer shut the door behind them. "We could shop for new clothes."

The two women made their way to the living room. Magazines, remotes, and coasters cluttered the coffee table. A mahogany fireplace sat between two matching bookshelves. Adora stood by the fireplace, scrutinizing the picture frames that dotted the

mantle shelf in front of the television. The scent of floral candles lingered in the air. Glimmer occupied a plush lavender sofa, observing the blonde. She rested her elbow against a white pillow.

"I'm guessing the people in those pictures are your family," Adora said. "You guys seemed happy."

"We were," Glimmer said. "Mom gets a little overprotective at times, but I still love her. She and Dad are wonderful parents."

"What's your aunt like?"

"As much as I love Castaspella, she can be pretty smothering."

Adora plopped onto the sofa. "Sometimes I wonder what my biological family would have been like. Maybe my parents had more love in their hearts than Shadow Weaver ever did. Perhaps I had a sibling looking for me."

Glimmer placed a hand onto Adora's shoulder, and the blonde flinched. "Did my touch make you uncomfortable?"

Adora sighed. "A little. It's related to my trauma. Shadow Weaver and my ex used to touch me whenever they were threatening to punish me."

"Next time, I'll ask first."

"I'm fine. So, about what you did back in the catacombs..." Adora paused for a moment before continuing. "It's nice of you to protect me. I don't know where Hordak went, though. Speaking of the catacombs, Shadow Weaver appeared to me as an astral projection. I told her off. In response, she threatened to bend me to her will."

"If she fucking tries anything, I'll make sure she doesn't bother you ever again."

"And what would you do if you see my ex?"

"Can you describe her?"

"Of course. Catra has brown hair, heterochromia eyes, freckles, and tan skin. She can turn into a werepanther. Wears a lot of red and black. Shorter than me, by a few inches."

Glimmer nodded. "If I ever see her, I'll use a spell that will prevent her from getting physically close to you."

"Would you be okay with me making friends with others?"

"Yes. Why do you ask? Has Catra or Shadow Weaver tried to isolate you?"

"They did, but Catra was more likely to do it because of her abandonment issues." Adora rose to her height. "I was asking because I don't want to be forced to isolate myself. Anyways, I want to get new clothes. I'm not going to wear the same outfit every day."

Glimmer smiled. "Alright. Let's go shopping."

---

The two women visited a mall in the center of Bright Moon City. It was a spacious, vast building, with tons of people walking in and out of stores. A few individuals bought snacks from food courts. Several children whined and screamed, begging their guardians to get them what they wanted so bad. Heels clacked against the marble tile, and the wall speakers emitted upbeat music. Glimmer led Adora to a clothing store. Browsing the racks, they perused the clothes and checking the prices. She spotted some clothes that would match her style. Nearby, Adora wandered around, hands brushing against vests, jackets, t-shirts, and denim shorts.

"Did you see anything you like?" Glimmer asked.

"Yes," Adora said as she collected a few clothing items. "I'll try them on."

A familiar blonde woman approached them. In one hand, Perfuma was holding a pink maxi dress. She smiled at Glimmer, then said, "Hello. Is this your new friend?"

"She is. Adora's living with me at the moment," Glimmer replied. "Adora, meet Perfuma."

Adora whirled around. "Nice to meet you, Perfuma."

"Glimmer told me about you," Perfuma said. "That aside, I'm going to try on this dress right now."

Glimmer and Adora continued their shopping. While she gathered a couple items, Adora winded up with a decent amount of clothing. By the time they were done, they purchased the clothes. With bags full, they exited the store and strode past a few shops. They found a bubble tea cafe, then ordered some drinks and sat down.

Adora slurped her tea. "I've never tried bubble tea before. It's so delicious!"

"It is," Glimmer replied. "Did you have fun shopping?"

"I had fun. How about you?"

"Same."

"You've been so nice to me."

"Yeah, because I like you. And you're a nice person, too."

They grabbed the bags and left the bubble tea cafe, continuing the conversation as they walked. The two women passed by several stores and stepped onto an escalator. Glimmer searched for more familiar faces. She spotted a few. Mermista and Sea Hawk emerged from a restaurant, holding hands. Bow was walking toward the exit, carrying a small bag. When he saw Glimmer, he waved at her. She returned the gesture. Adora wore a soft smile, then glanced at her.

"Is he another one of your friends?" Adora asked.

"Yeah," Glimmer said. "We went to the same school."

"Did the two of you ever date?"

"No. He had been interested in other people. Bow and I are like brother and sister."

"Have you ever dated anyone?"

"I don't think I have." Glimmer led Adora to the exit and opened the door for her. "I was focused on surviving school. There might have been an occassional crush, but that's it."

"Surviving high school should have been my focus during my teen years," Adora said. "To be fair, teenagers don't always make the wisest decisions. My worst decision is getting into a relationship with Catra. I can't remember which one of us initiated the relationship, though."

They strode across the parking lot. On their way to the car, a few vehicles moved in front of them several times. Clouds blotted out the sunlight. Humidity blanketed the city. Glimmer couldn't wait for cooler temperatures and for her favorite season. Autumn. The time when leaves would change color, and the weather wasn't too hot or cold. Winter was decent, too, with its quiet, snowy mornings, but the main drawback was icy roads. Once the two women reached Glimmer's car, they heaved the bags into its trunk.

---

Evening came. Adora and Glimmer finished putting away their new clothes, then ordered pizza. After receiving the pizza, Glimmer carried the boxes into the kitchen and set them on the island counter. Adora occupied a mahogany barstool and watched as Glimmer retrieved the plates and cups. The delicious smell of pizza made her stomach growl. She pressed her elbows against the counter, gazing at the vintage decor, frilly curtains, and white

cabinets. Compared to the kitchen in her old home, this one was fancy.

"Do you want to watch a movie or two?" Glimmer asked as she handed a plate to Adora. "I have some good ones."

"A movie sounds fun," Adora said.

The two women took their plates and drinks to the living room. While eating the pizza, they figured out what to watch first. There were many movies to choose from. Adora picked an animated movie from the late 90s about a girl who saved China. A vague memory of the movie surfaced as she pushed the disc into the player. She sat next to Glimmer and grabbed a remote, then hit the play button. As the movie started, they made comments regarding the film. Glimmer mentioned owning a doll version of the heroine. An hour whizzed by, and as soon as the credits rolled, they proceeded to watch several more movies.

When it was midnight, Adora and Glimmer went to their respective rooms. She reclined on her new bed and pulled the covers over her body. Before falling asleep, she checked her phone for reports of vampires and demons. So far, she hadn't seen any information. She scrolled through social media, exhaustion seeping into her body as she read a few posts. There were two friend requests; one from Glimmer, and the other from Perfuma. She accepted both.

Adora turned off the phone, its light fading away as she placed it on the nightstand. Darkness flooded the room, shadows lurking in the corners. Closing her eyes, she took in deep breaths. The temperature sank. Ten minutes before one in the morning, she drifted to dreamland. Her fingers dug into the blanket as she tossed back and forth. Images surfaced, despite her efforts to keep the nightmares at bay.

...

*Adora had just finished climbing out of her bedroom window. The coolness of night enveloped her. Shivering, she zipped up her jacket, but it did little to help. Catra waited on the sidewalk, leaning against a motorcycle. As long as the blonde remained quiet, she would succeed in sneaking out. If her adoptive mother caught her, or if the police brought her home, she would be forced to listen to the old woman's angry lecture. The two teens mounted the motorcycle. Lights flooded the windows.*

*"Crap," Adora whispered.*

*Catra steered the motorcycle into the street. The next thing Adora knew, she winded up in a dark forest, surrounded by barren trees. Disembodied growls drilled into her ears. Making her way along the dirt path, she searched for an exit. All she saw was miles and miles of trees. Twigs snapped behind her, and she patted her pants for a weapon, only to find none. She broke into a run, her heartbeat accelerating as she scanned the area for a shelter. Her foot met a log, and she fell forward.*

*The moment Adora rolled onto her back, she froze. Shadow Weaver and Catra glowered at her. The latter was in beast form, large muscles tense with anger. As far as she knew, she rarely saw them together. She struggled to remember something, anything, that could give them a reason to be in the same area.*

*"You made a promise," Catra said, despite being in her werepanther form.*

*"Maybe I should have left you in the orphanage," Shadow Weaver said.*

*Adora forced herself to rise. "What did I do to make you treat me this way?"*

*"You disobeyed me," Shadow Weaver spat.*

*"You broke up with me," Catra said in a distorted voice as she lunged at Adora.*

*Catra pinned Adora to the ground and swung a paw at her face.*

...

A scream erupted from Adora's throat as she sat up. The outlines of the window, curtains, and a single dresser took shape. A soft creak drew her attention to the door. Light flooded the room, and within seconds, Glimmer stood by the edge of her bed. The shorter woman wore a concerned expression. Adora's scream must have been loud enough for her friend to hear.

"Are you okay?" Glimmer asked.

"Yeah. Sorry for waking you up," Adora said.

"I don't mind, because I'm a night owl. Anyways, do you want to talk about it?"

"It was a nightmare about Shadow Weaver and Catra."

Glimmer reached out to touch Adora, but pulled back as soon as she did. "Can I touch you? I'll be gentle."

Adora shrugged. "I guess."

Glimmer began caressing Adora's arms. "You're safe. No one will hurt you as long as I'm here."

Chapter End Notes

Twitter handle: @xAdore_thatx

Tumblr: @thatadorablewarriorlady

Discord server: https://discord.gg/2ACUqRCq

# Chapter 4

Chapter Notes

This chapter is a little shorter than the others.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The morning light illuminated the kitchen. Adora stared out the window, waiting for the coffee to brew. She leaned against the counter, tapping her fingers on the cool surface. The manor was quiet, and Glimmer hadn't awakened yet. They would be roommates for the time being. By saving her in the catacombs and calming her after a nightmare, Glimmer had shown her that she was a good friend. Adora would like to return the favor in some way. The shorter woman's kindness warmed her heart, and there was something comforting about the way Glimmer touched her.

Last time Adora was in a relationship, she allowed her ex to abuse her. Back then, a part of her hoped that Catra would calm down and get better. But Catra didn't improve. If she were to be in a relationship with Glimmer, what would her friend do if they had a disagreement? The coffee machine beeped, interrupting her thoughts. She set the mug onto the counter and poured a creamer into her drink. Then, she grabbed the mug and occupied a seat by the table. She checked her phone for any reports regarding vampires and demons.

Footsteps entered the kitchen, garnering Adora's attention. Glimmer headed for the coffee and poured the bitter liquid into a mug. The woman's dyed strands stuck in multiple directions.

"Good morning," Adora said.

"Morning. How did you sleep?" Glimmer asked as she sat next to Adora.

"I slept fine. Thanks for asking."

"Did you have any more nightmares?"

"No. I think it's because you comforted me last night." Adora rose to her height. "Anyways, I'm going to make some breakfast." She searched the cabinets for a pancake mix, then pulled out a box. "Do pancakes sound good?"

"Yes," Glimmer said.

Adora took out an electric griddle and a mixing bowl. Time passed as she combined the ingredients in the bowl and poured the batter into the griddle, making four circles. Glimmer retrieved strawberries from the fridge, then washed them and cut off the leafy parts. Once the pancakes were ready, Adora flipped the pancakes onto a pair of plates.

Both women sprinkled strawberries onto their respective plates and occupied their seats. Adora scrutinized her phone. Still no reports. There had to be something to do. She was a hunter, after all. And what was she doing the whole time? Sitting around?

"I should be doing more as a hunter," Adora said. "Maybe I could try patrolling some areas after the sun goes down."

"We could do that together," Glimmer replied. "Patrolling an area at night, I mean. Anyways, if you're not slaying monsters, what do you do in your free time?"

Adora dug her fork into the pancakes and sliced off a small triangle. "I work out, and I practice fighting. What do you like to do?"

"I watch movies, write in my journal, and practice spellcasting."

"Speaking of movies, I enjoyed watching them last night."

"Is there anything you want to do today?"

Adora lifted the fork to her lips. "I don't know. Why do you ask?"

"Because today's my day off," Glimmer said.

"Okay. Maybe we could spar?"

Glimmer shrugged. "I guess we could. We'll do it after breakfast."

The two women chatted as they continued eating breakfast. By the time they were done, they cleaned up the kitchen and changed their clothes. While Adora wore a red tank top and gray shorts, Glimmer wore a lavender t-shirt with denim shorts. They went out into the backyard. Clouds glided across the bright blue sky. As warm as the weather was, they weren't about to let a little heat stop them from sparring.

They proceeded to spar. Adora was surprised at Glimmer's speed. As she blocked some blows, her forearms took the brunt. Dodging an uppercut, she charged at the shorter woman. They exchanged blows, punches, and they also parried. Eventually, Glimmer gained the upper hand. The warm temperature rose into the high 80s, and both women began sweating.

"It's gonna be noon in a bit," Adora said between pants, wiping the sweat off her forehead.

"It was fun sparring, though," Glimmer replied.

"You did great."

"You, too."

---

By noon, Glimmer and Adora decided to take a drive around Bright Moon City, looking for something to do. They settled on visiting the library, where Hope Light worked. The woman in question was tall and slim, and she wore a head covering. Hope seemed to have a lot to say, yet she always defaulted to being vague. On some topics, however, she was like a textbook.

"Have you been training?" Hope asked.

"Yes. This morning," Adora replied.

"I see you've made a friend."

"Of course. Her name is Glimmer. She's been nice."

"Attachments may hinder you. There was another hunter who couldn't handle her responsibility due to her attachments. Her name is Mara. She was supposed to put an end to the world of demons and other dark creatures. Yet she ended up being compromised."

Adora tilted her head. "Attachments? My friend hasn't hindered me. She's helpful."

Hope placed a stack of books onto the front desk. "A hunter works alone. At one point, you may have to let go. Anyways, you can take those books home."

"Have you ever had a friend?" Adora waited for a response, only to receive nothing but a strange look on Hope's face. "Okay. It's fine if you don't want to answer." She gathered the books.

Adora and Glimmer left the library. Either Hope Light didn't have any luck with friendships, or some hunters in the past had success while working alone. Who was Mara, and why couldn't that woman handle her responsibility? Had Mara been involved with a dark creature? Or someone who sought to bring her down? More and more questions whizzed through Adora's mind as she followed Glimmer across the street.

"Is there anything else you want to do?" Glimmer asked as they walked down a sidewalk.

"I don't know," Adora replied.

"Hmm..." Glimmer's gaze scanned the area. A building seemed to grab her attention. Its sign had an illustration of roller skates. "Oh. How about roller-skating?"

"Never tried it before."

"Well, it could be fun." Glimmer led Adora into the building.

Both women retrieved roller-skating shoes from a rack, slipped them on, and began gliding on the rink. Adora held out her arms in an attempt to maintain her balance. Glimmer's hand enveloped hers as they continued moving. Retro music mingled with snatches of conversations. Adora grabbed Glimmer's other hand, her eyes meeting the shorter woman's gaze. Because she didn't have any experience with roller-skating, there was a chance she could lose her balance. Suddenly, she fell backward, pulling Glimmer down. The blonde's spine met the floor. Glimmer was on top of Adora, her palms and knees resting on the floor.

In an instant, Adora's mind transported to that time Catra pinned her on a bed, holding her wrists in place. The brunette's nails had penetrated her wrists. Every muscle in her body froze. She felt a phantom sensation of sharp nails scratching her cheek. Lost in the memory and unable to move, she took in shallow breaths. Her racing heart thrashed against her ribs. A familiar voice snapped her back to reality.

"What's wrong?" Glimmer asked, furrowing her brows.

"I just froze," Adora replied.

Glimmer rose, then helped Adora up. "Why did you freeze?"

"I know you didn't hurt me, but when you sat on top of me, I had a flashback of Catra pinning me," Adora said.

They proceeded toward the edge of the rink, put on their regular shoes, and sat down. Adora couldn't believe she had a flashback in the middle of their time together. She knew she could get help for her trauma, but most therapists in the area could charge a lot of money for one session. Also, she had responsibilities that came with being a hunter. Hopefully she could move on from her trauma without needing therapy.

"What did Catra do when she pinned you?" Glimmer asked.

"She would dig her nails into my skin. At times, she would scratch me," Adora said.

"That's awful."

"It is."

"So..." Glimmer stood. "That aside, do you want to do anything else today?"

"How about we go home?"

"Sure."

---

Nighttime surrounded the city. Adora decided to patrol a cemetery by the Whispering Woods. This time, Glimmer accompanied her. The temperature had dropped to the low 70s. She had two options; explore the catacombs, or go into the forest. As she approached the mausoleum, something or someone moved toward the iron fence. She observed the shadow. It was shaped like an animal, and it could be one. She shone the flashlight in its direction. Mismatched eyes gleamed in the darkness. As Adora moved closer, she pulled out a dagger. Something about the heterochromia eyes seemed familiar. She waited for it to move. Yet it remained still, perhaps watching her.

Glimmer approached her. "Did you find something?"

Adora pointed at the creature. "Yes."

The creature climbed over the fence, then advanced. Its eyes fixated on Adora. Could this be Catra in werepanther form? It was possible that Catra ran all the way through the forest. The Whispering Woods had always served as a boundary between Bright Moon City and Fright Zone City. It was a large forest spanning miles. If someone had to go from this city to Fright Zone by car, it would take a few hours.

Pushing those thoughts aside, Adora pointed her dagger at the werepanther. The beast rose, standing on its hind legs. Catra lunged at her, knocking her off her feet. Glimmer levitated Catra, then flung the werepanther toward the fence.

Adora forced herself up. "Catra found me."

Glimmer stared at the werepanther. "So, we've met."

Catra's ears flattened against her head as she growled. Adora tossed the dagger at her, and the werepanther was quick to dodge the blade. Glimmer took out a potion bottle and chucked the vial at Catra. A subtle scent of wolfsbane wafted into the air. The werepanther reclined on the grass. Adora retrieved her dagger, keeping an eye on the werepanther as she walked.

"She'll be out for an hour or so," Glimmer said as she turned her attention to Adora. "Are you okay?"

"Yeah," Adora said. "Let's check the catacombs."

Both women entered the catacombs. The tunnels were similar to the ones Adora had explored, but this one had empty coffins. A few corpses sported fang marks on their necks. Were there vampires in this place? Shining the flashlight at the archways and tightening her grip on the dagger, she led Glimmer through the passageway. They stepped into a room and saw that its only light source was a single torch. A vampire lingered by a stone coffin.

The vampire hissed at them as it lunged. Adora leaped out of the way, and as she moved closer, someone grabbed her neck from behind. A growl drilled into her ear as she swung her elbow back and connected. Once she broke free of the assailant's grip, she took a closer look at the person who grabbed her. As it turned out, her attacker was a vampire. She plunged the dagger into the vampire's chest. Glimmer tossed a potion at the other vampire's feet. Smoke enveloped the creature, and in an instant, the vampire disappeared.

"Let's see if there are any more in this place," Adora said.

The two women made their way through the dim tunnels. An hour dragged on, and at one point, they battled more vampires. By the time they left the catacombs and entered their car, Adora glanced out the window. If Catra woke up, would the werepanther return to Fright Zone City? Or would Catra track Adora down?

"Did you see anything else?" Glimmer asked as she backed the car out of the parking lot.

"No," Adora said. "I was thinking about what Catra might do upon waking up."

Chapter End Notes

Twitter handle: @xAdore_thatx

Tumblr: @thatadorablewarriorlady

# Chapter 5

Chapter Notes

> From this chapter on, there might be a few scenes in Catra's POV, but Glimmer and Adora are still the main characters.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Morning came. Adora awakened with a start, fragments of a dream lingering. In the dream, she saw a brunette woman hunting vampires and demons. The woman wore clothes that belonged in the 1800s. So did other people in the vision. Another woman, called Serenia, had accompanied the brunette on missions. At one point, they had visited a village named Alwyn. The dream had ended when Serenia mentioned Mara dying. Had it been an insight into the past? What did Mara die from? Did making some kind of mistake lead to the previous hunter's demise? Pushing her thoughts aside, she scooted off the bed and changed her clothes.

Adora descended the stairs and entered the living room. Once she turned on her phone, she looked up Alwyn. According to the town's website, it was once a populated town, with the occasional visitor passing through. Then, something made its residents flee. She scrolled to a photo gallery of Alwyn. Most of them were sepia-toned. There were a few before-and-after photos of abandoned buildings. They must have fallen apart after years of being untouched.

Footsteps gained Adora's attention. She glanced up in time to see Glimmer sit on the couch. "Morning. You're up a little early."

"It's nine," Glimmer said.

"Anyways, I had a strange dream regarding Mara. She has a friend named Serenia. They must have lived in the 1800s, judging by the clothes they wore. Also, I saw an abandoned town, Alwyn, a place that used to be populated."

"What was Mara doing in the dream?" Glimmer asked.

"Hunting dark creatures. Serenia helped her out sometimes. That aside, I looked up Alwyn on my phone. The town's residents fled. It has been vacant ever since."

"There are rumors of Alwyn being haunted."

"Something did scare off the people who lived there." Adora rose to her height. "Even Alwyn's website didn't have any information on whatever had made them leave." She strode toward the kitchen. "Maybe they saw a demon or a vampire."

"It could be a possibility."

"I'd like to investigate Alwyn."

Glimmer followed Adora into the kitchen. "I'm working today, so I'll be off by three."

Adora sat by the table. "While you're at work, I'll read the books that Hope Light gave to me. Those books are about being a hunter. Stuff about demons, vampires, and other dark creatures. I'll go to the park after breakfast."

"What would you do if Catra shows up?"

"I might ask her to leave me alone, though she could probably keep bothering me."

"I don't want her to hurt you."

Adora rested her elbow on the table. "In case she does, I'll defend myself."

Glimmer shrugged. "Still, she was aggressive." She proceeded to brew a pot of coffee. "And she had been awful to you in the past."

"I know. But I'll be fine."

Catra had been exploring this strange city for an hour, not sure how she winded up here. She recalled waking up in a cemetery. A blurry memory surfaced. Did she fight Adora in her werepanther form? And who was the person that tossed a vial at her? As she made her way into an alley, she sensed someone watching her. Even in her human form, she had the strength to easily fight off an attacker. Her gaze swept every inch of the alley, keeping herself alert for the slightest indication of danger. Sure enough, a group of people surrounded her. A tall, large man stepped forward. He sported tattoos on his arms and wore bandages on his hands.

"This is Tung Lashor's domain, little girl," the man said.

"Tung Lashor?" Catra asked. "Either it's your name, or there's a bigger boss behind the scenes with an unfortunate name." She crossed her arms.

"I'm the big boss around here. Huntara was a traitor. She sold out some of our members. Guess being a vigilante didn't satisfy her."

"What do you want?"

"You're challenging me?" Tung Lashor chuckled, staring Catra down. "I'll crush you. I've seen enough of your type. The little wimps who act tough, but are scared of me."

Laughter erupted from Catra's throat as she threw her head back. "Classic! The cliched 'I am so big and scary' line is old. I'm sure you've used it on people so many times."

"Shut the fuck up." Tung Lashor scowled. "It has worked so far."

"I'm not gonna back down."

"It is on."

Catra widened her stance. So did Tung Lashor. They began throwing punches and kicks at each other. Each time he assumed that he won, she would outsmart him. Even with her "human"

senses, she could smell the exhaustion and desperation coming off of him. Channeling her strength throughout her body, she rammed her shoulder into his abdomen, wrapped her arms around his waist, and pinned him to the ground. She stole his knife and pressed the tip of the blade against his jaw.

"You lost," Catra said. "Any last words? There's another side of me that is much, much stronger."

"Well... fuck," Tung Lashor whispered.

"Hey, guys." Catra smirked at the gangsters. "Who's the strongest? I am. The name's Catra." She rose to her height.

A woman with grey hair and lilac highlights came forward. "Catra is the strongest. Go home, Tung Lashor. We have a new leader."

A short, muscular woman with navy highlights nodded. "Daisy's right. Catra is awesome. Guess what... Rogelio, Kyle, and Lonnie? Catra's gonna lead the gang."

Catra held up her palms. "Contain your excitement. I'm from Fright Zone City, and I somehow got into this place. Anyways... have you ever seen a girl with blonde hair, fair skin, and steel-blue eyes? Adora usually wears red. And she always wears a ponytail."

Lonnie tilted her head. "We never met someone named Adora. Are you looking for her?"

"Kind of. As leader of the gang, I order you guys to find her."

Kyle furrowed his brows. "Why is Adora so important to you?"

Catra gritted her teeth. "She left me. I'll get her back, whether she likes it or not."

Daisy cleared her throat. "Bright Moon City is huge. It'll take us a long time to search every single place for this Adora person."

"I wish I had a picture of Adora, but I must have left it at home. Just... ask any blonde girl around here, okay?" Catra asked.

The goons nodded. Catra said, "You guys need to split up and search for her. If you find her, bring her to me."

---

Adora found a shaded area in the park and sat on the ground, her back pressing against a tree. She proceeded to read the books she had borrowed from Hope Light. Time dragged on as she scrutinized the pages. A variety of sounds mingled; Children laughing, birds singing, and dogs barking. An aroma of food cooking on the grill made her mouth water. As she turned the page, a twig snapped, prompting her to glance at whoever approached her.

The stranger was a dark-skinned woman whose dreadlocks were pulled into a short ponytail. "Are you Adora?"

"Why do you ask?" Adora replied as she closed the book.

"Someone I just met is looking for Adora."

"Who wants to find me? And who are you?"

"Catra. Also, I'm Lonnie."

Adora shot up to her height. "Tell her you didn't find anything."

Lonnie crossed her arms. "I'm pretty sure you're this 'Adora' Catra is talking about. Steel-blue eyes, blonde ponytail, and wears red."

"Did she hire you?"

"Not exactly." Lonnie pointed to a depiction of bat wings on her left sleeve. "She found our gang. I mean, club."

Adora moved past Lonnie. She didn't have a good feeling about this. "In case you haven't noticed, I was in the middle of reading library books. And you interrupted."

Lonnie grabbed Adora's wrist. "Catra told us to get you."

Adora pulled away. "Stop bothering me. I'll be quick to defend myself if you resort to violence." She hurried toward the parking lot. "I don't want to cause a scene out here, so forget about it."

"I'll return with backup next time."

Adora entered her car and locked the doors. Backing out of the parking lot, she steered the vehicle onto the street. If Catra was looking for her, it meant that the werepanther hadn't left Bright Moon City. She stopped at a red light. Shaking her head, she swore under her breath. Traffic had just congested the street, and she hated it. Couldn't she have some time to herself while reading? And why was Catra obsessed with tracking her down? She clenched her jaw, tightening her grip on the wheel until her knuckles blanched. What made Catra resort to using a gang to pursue her? Was the werepanther desperate?

---

"Stop bothering her and leave the flower shop," Glimmer said to a muscular man.

The man had green highlights in his hair, and he sported scars on his bare arms. "I thought it was Adora because of the hair color. Are they sisters?"

"They're not sisters." Glimmer clenched her fists, then leaned against the counter. "Anyways, who's making you search for her?"

"Catra."

"Well, whoever Catra is, she's looking in all the wrong places. So go away."

"Fine."

The man stormed off. Perfuma stepped toward Glimmer. "What was his deal? People such as him crimp my harmony. Testing my patience and weirding me out, that is."

Glimmer shrugged as she placed the arrangements onto the shelves. The shop wasn't busy today. Her mind wasn't on work. Instead, she was thinking about Adora. All because Catra had the audacity to send suspicious people around Bright Moon City in a desperate attempt to find Adora. If she ever saw Catra again, there would be hell to pay. The werepanther would rue the day. She sent a text message to Adora, just in case something happened to the blonde. As soon as she sent the message, her phone chimed.

**12:16**
**Adora:** I'm going home. Just ran into some girl. She said that Catra asked her to find me.

**Glimmer:** Let me guess. Another person with bat wings insignia on their clothing.

**Adora:** Yep.

Glimmer pushed the phone into her pocket. Once the door opened, she strode to the counter. Bow had just entered the shop, and when he glanced at Perfuma, he waved. Maybe he was on a lunch break. Either he was here to ask Perfuma out, or he came in here to see his girlfriend. Perfuma winked at him.

"Hello, Bow," Perfuma said, smiling.

"Hey," Bow replied. "Are you free tonight?"

"Yes."

"Would you like to go out with me tonight?"

Perfuma rose her brows. "Of course. Do you have a place in mind?"

Glimmer carried more arrangements to half-empty displays, trying not to listen to their conversation. The couple mentioned a few options for date night. She spotted someone waiting outside the window, but the individual was holding a box. Probably a delivery

for the shop. She walked outside, retrieved the box, and hurried back inside. So far, the only people to visit the shop were the rude man, the delivery person, and Bow.

"I'll see you tonight!" Bow said as he went to the door.

"Same!" Perfuma replied in a cheerful tone.

Glimmer placed the box onto the arranging table. "Perfuma, where are you going tonight?"

Perfuma chortled. "A bar. Speaking of romance, have you and Adora started falling in love?"

"At the moment, we're friends."

"It'll be a shame to miss an opportunity. At one point, someone has to make the first move."

Glimmer opened the box. "She had a bad experience with a past relationship, so I don't want her to feel as though we have to rush things."

"Oh, okay," Perfuma said. "Still, I think romance will come at the right time."

Chapter End Notes

Twitter handle: @xAdore_thatx
Tumblr: @thatadorablewarriorlady

# Chapter 6

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

By four in the afternoon, Glimmer and Adora visited Alwyn. The town was so quiet, one could hear the pin drop. Or the wind howling. Glimmer brought along an ouija board and some potions, while Adora took her usual weapons. As seen in the pictures, the houses were falling apart. Missing windows, fallen doors, and broken roofs indicated a lack of maintenance. Bushes and overgrowth had occupied the fences and gates. Brick foundations threatened to crumble beneath the weight of vacant homes. Willow trees swayed in the breeze, adding to Alwyn's spooky appearance. The two women approached a two-story house with wooden columns.

Glimmer set the ouija board onto the stone walkway. "I'm not going in there and dealing with creepy crawlies, so I'll stick to being out here." She pressed her fingers against a planchette.

"I'm going in," Adora said.

Adora made her way to the entrance. She turned on her flashlight, then stepped inside. As she guessed, this place was dark. A thick layer of dust and debris idled on the floor and stairs. She shone her flashlight into a dining room. Someone had left the dinnerware on the table. The temperature sank as she crept closer. A feeling of being watched sent a shiver cascading down her spine. A whisper drifted into her ears, and she peered over her shoulder. She strode to a living room and spied a large painting above the fireplace. Heavy footsteps walked toward the shattered window.

A shadow flickered, and Adora caught a whiff of a smoky scent. A small part of her recalled the ghost stories she listened to during her childhood. Disembodied voices pierced the silence. She

strained to listen, hoping they could provide some clues as to what made Alwyn's residents flee. However, the words were jumbled. A phantom sensation of fingers brushed her shoulder. An urge to race out the door overwhelmed her.

A resounding thud drew Adora's attention to a bookshelf. She tried to ignore her racing heartbeat and the tension in her limbs as she proceeded into the entryway. Tree branches scraped at the windows. She drew her dagger and observed her surroundings. Just then, something skittered over her feet. A mouse? Or an insect? Taking in a deep breath to calm her nerves, she moved toward the stairs. A translucent silhouette raced down the steps.

A distorted scream drilled into Adora's ears. She rushed outside and halted once she found Glimmer. The shorter woman was taking notes and speaking to an invisible entity. Glimmer made eye contact.

"Did you see a ghost?" Glimmer asked.

"I saw a shadow. And heard noises," Adora replied.

"You're not scared, are you?"

Adora smiled. "What? No!"

"Then why did you come out here as soon as you went in?"

"Uh, because I wanted to?"

"That aside, I gathered some information regarding the reason Alwyn's residents left." Glimmer displayed the notes. "According to a spirit, a chimera has attacked the town. There were also reports of a chupacabra killing the livestock."

"Is there anything else? Where are they located?" Adora asked.

Glimmer peeked at the notes. "Well, it says an underground tunnel. Dark creatures sure enjoy being underground."

"We don't have a map of Alwyn's tunnel."

"Fortunately, I know a spell that'll lead us there," Glimmer said.

Adora glanced around, scrutinizing the area. She was vaguely aware of Glimmer's chanting as she watched for more signs of ghosts. Sure enough, doors slammed by themselves, and disembodied voices shouted. Once Glimmer finished chanting, the two women searched for an underground tunnel. It didn't take long for them to find it. As they navigated the passageway, Adora kept her senses on high alert. A decaying stench flooded her nose. *Do they not have proper burials?* She wouldn't be surprised if she saw a rotting corpse. They passed a small wagon. Rats squeaked, scurrying across the dirt floor.

"Are we ever going to find what we're looking for?" Adora asked as they entered a room. She could see outlines of barrels and wooden crates. The moment she shone her flashlight at the crates, a pair of red eyes glowed. Then, she heard a sinister growl.

A creature emerged. It turned out to be a chupacabra, with spines running down its back. The chupacabra had greenish-gray skin. It lunged at Adora, but she was quick to dodge the attack. She chucked the dagger at its chest, halting its movements. The creature disintegrated to ashes. Where was the chimera, though?

"Watch out!" Glimmer shouted.

Something knocked Adora forward, making her land onto her stomach. A foul breath heated the back of her neck. Claws sunk through her shirt and dug into her flesh. A flashback of Catra's nails flooded her mind as she fought to quell the rising panic in her chest. Fangs penetrated her arm. She looked up at Glimmer.

Glimmer levitated the beast off of Adora's back and sent it flying toward the wall. Adora forced herself to rise, and as she retrieved the dagger, the creature exhaled flames at the duo. Flames

emerged from the ground, illuminating the room. She checked her wounded arm and saw twin marks on her forearm.

"Adora, are you okay?" Glimmer asked.

"The chimera bit me," Adora said. "I'll be fine, so don't worry."

"We're not going to ignore that wound!" Glimmer shook her head as she glowered at the chimera and tossed a potion.

The vial shattered, startling the chimera. Glimmer murmured an incantation. In an instant, the beast vanished. She unleashed an extinguishing spell, eliminating the flames. Then, she conjured a spell to remove any trace of poison from Adora's wound.

---

Once they went home, Glimmer bandaged Adora's arm. Although they vanquished the demons lurking in Alwyn's tunnel, they hadn't discovered answers regarding Mara and Serenia. They sat at the dining table, eating Chinese takeout. From time to time, Adora stole glances at the shorter woman. When Glimmer caught one of those glances, she flashed a smile.

"I like your smile," Adora said.

"Thanks," Glimmer replied. A blush formed on her cheeks.

*Gosh, she is so cute.* Adora's heart fluttered. Didn't she have those same feelings for Catra during her teen years? She had thought that she was done with dating, but a part of her was drawn to Glimmer. Pushing such thoughts aside, she placed the empty takeout boxes into the trash can and carried the silverware to the sink.

"There has to be some written record of Mara and Serenia somewhere. Maybe they have biographies or journals," Adora said.

"I could summon their spirits," Glimmer replied as she rose. "I'll get the candles."

Once Glimmer rushed upstairs, Adora made her way into the living room and plopped onto the couch. She picked up a remote, then pressed the power button. The television flashed to life, displaying a scene. Flipping through the channels, she looked for something interesting to watch. One of them halted her channel-surfing. A picture of a little boy from her dream stood out to her. He was standing next to a blonde girl. A couple stood behind them, smiling for the camera. The documentary started off with a couple taking their newborn twins home from the hospital. According to the narrator, they lived in Grayskull City. They were a happy family, as they lived in a gorgeous home, went on road trips, and owned a cat.

The twins did everything together. One fateful day, when they were five, everything changed. An intruder had stormed into their house and murdered Marlena and Randor Glenn. The little boy, whose name was Adam, fled the house in a panic. Adora's heart skipped a beat. *I said his name in a dream.* The entryway in the scene was the same. She couldn't believe it.

The story continued, with the twins being seperated at the orphanage. They hadn't seen each other since. The woman who had adopted Adora refused to let her see Adam. It hadn't stopped Adam from wanting to see his sister. He would ask his adoptive family over and over. His guardians would attempt to contact Shadow Weaver, and guess what she did each time? She ignored them. As if reuniting the twins wasn't even important.

The camera focused on an older Adam. He resembled Adora, but he had reddish blonde hair and dark blue eyes. "I know she's out there. Wherever she is, I hope she's living a happy life. I hope that I'll see her again."

Releasing an audible sigh, Adora turned off the television. What did she just watch? Memories of her childhood sprang to the surface. She recalled playing with her brother, swinging toy swords at each other. They once made a fort using blankets and chairs in the middle of the living room. She and Adam used to take turns playing a game centered around a green-clad

protagonist. The twins had so much fun together, only to be separated at such a young age.

"Adora, I got the candles," Glimmer announced as she descended the stairs. "Wait. Are you okay? I can hear you crying."

Adora became aware of the tears streaming down her face. She wiped the tears off her cheeks. What would her life be like if her biological parents didn't die? Glimmer's hand touched her shoulder, interrupting her thoughts. Violet eyes peered into her bright blues.

Adora took in a deep breath. "I... I watched a documentary. It was about separated twins. Adam and I were the twins mentioned in the documentary."

"How do you know for sure if it was your family?" Glimmer asked, caressing Adora's arms.

"Just watch the whole thing. Or look it up. It's called Separated at Five: The Story of the Glenn Twins."

Glimmer set the candles onto the coffee tables and yanked a phone from her pocket. The screen's light illuminated her face as she typed the title into a search engine. Sure enough, the search returned with pictures and clips. She tapped one of the clips. By the time the video ended, she made eye contact.

"This Adam guy looks so much like you, it's uncanny," Glimmer said.

"The story still hasn't revealed the person who killed my biological parents," Adora replied. "I'll search for answers in Grayskull City. The problem is, Adam hasn't revealed his current location."

"Maybe there's some way to contact him." Glimmer typed in the name of the city. "According to the map, it'll take two days to get there."

"I think Shadow Weaver must have moved to Fright Zone after adopting me. She had isolated me from the only family I had left."

Glimmer placed the phone onto the coffee table and arranged the candles on the floor. "What a bitch. It was unneccessary of her to do that to you."

Adora nodded. "I know, right?"

"I think it's because if you and Adam had grown up together, albeit in different homes, the other family would have discovered that Shadow Weaver was an abusive guardian." Glimmer lit the candles. "You deserved better."

Glimmer began chanting. Despite the closed doors and windows, a gust of wind blew past the circle of candles. A spirit materialized in the center. They happened to be a woman, with platinum blonde hair and fair skin. The woman wore a riding skirt and a button-up shirt from the 1800s.

"I'm Serenia, a friend of Mara," the woman said. "Where am I?"

"Your spirit is in the twenty-first century," Glimmer replied as she turned her attention to Adora. "Mara didn't come. I intended to summon her."

"Mara?" Serenia asked. "Isn't she gone?"

"She is."

Adora cleared her throat. "Serenia... how did Mara die? Did she really become compromised?"

Serenia opened her mouth, then pressed her lips together, wearing a vacant look. Mara must have meant something to her. Silence filled the air as she began shimmering. Within seconds, the spirit disappeared. She probably didn't want to talk about Mara's fate.

Would Adora ever have answers regarding Mara? And would she find Adam someday?

Chapter End Notes

Twitter handle: @xAdore_thatx
Tumblr: @thatadorablewarriorlady

# Chapter 7

A month passed since Glimmer summoned Serenia. The weather had started getting a little cooler, although there were still warm days. Adora had visited the library from time to time. Whenever she asked Hope Light about Mara, she would receive a vague answer. It wasn't the only thing that frustrated her. She had searched for her brother on social media, but it wouldn't return any results. One night, she had another dream. It was as vivid as the others she had in the past...

...

*"Are you sure you want to cut your life short?" Serenia asked Mara as they stood in the middle of a barren field.*

*Mara gazed at the stars. "If sacrificing myself would delay them, I'll do it."*

*"You don't have to do this, you know. I love you."*

*"I love you, too. I'm doing this to save the world. If Horde Prime succeeds in unleashing every supernatural monster from the underworld, the human race will perish."*

*Serenia shook her head. "There has to be another way."*

*Mara sighed. "We're almost out of time. I have to do this, as unpleasant as it sounds. I don't see any other way."*

*"So, you're going to let yourself die?"*

*Mara nodded. She placed her hand onto Serenia's face. For a moment that seemed like forever, they held each other's gaze. Thunder boomed in the distance, and dark clouds concealed the stars and moon. A portal materialized. The two women embraced each other, weeping as Serenia buried her face into Mara's chest. Then, the brunette broke away and jumped into the portal. A blinding flash penetrated the darkness, and once the light*

*dimmed, the portal vanished. So did Mara. Serenia descended to the ground, burying her face in her hands.*

...

Adora's eyes fluttered open. Did she just have a dream about Mara's death? Was the woman's sacrifice the reason Hope Light said that Mara was compromised? She glanced at the alarm clock. ***1:15am.*** *Guess I should go back to sleep.* A memory of Hordak mentioning Horde Prime surfaced. Would she have to sacrifice herself someday, too? She was a hunter, and the human world was depending on her to protect the innocent from supernatural monsters.

As Adora closed her eyes, darkness wrapped around her mind. Drifting into a slumber, she felt herself returning to dreamland. She turned to her left side and pulled the covers over her body. A blurry image surfaced. Then, a familiar voice spoke...

...

*"I hope that I'll see her again."*

*Adora found herself standing in front of a sign. It said: "Grayskull City." Skyscrapers stretched into the sky. A single bridge spanned the distance over the large river. She blinked, and the next thing she knew, she winded up in the middle of a neighborhood. A two-story house with a single turret and scalloped roofing loomed over a flagstone walkway. A string of numbers and a street name flashed before her. She attempted to read the address, but the letters and numbers were jumbled.*

...

Adora awakened. Again. The dream was strange. She did recall the jumbled address and the house. Peeking at the alarm clock, she emitted a groan. Although those two dreams weren't nightmares, they kept waking her up in the middle of the night. She swung her legs over the edge of the bed and walked out of the room. Everything around her was pitch-black. She pressed a

hand against the wall, guiding herself toward the stairs. As she made her way downstairs, the boards creaked.

By the time Adora entered the kitchen, she grabbed a carton of milk and a glass cup. She poured the milk into the cup and leaned against the counter. So far, the manor was silent. A creak drew her attention as she sipped the milk. Footsteps shuffled into the kitchen. The ceiling light filled the room with a dim light as Glimmer occupied a barstool.

"Couldn't sleep, either?" Adora asked.

"No," Glimmer said in a tired voice.

"Guess we'll have another midnight conversation." Adora's fingers drummed the counter. "What caused you to have trouble sleeping?"

"I had a dream about Catra hurting you," Glimmer said.

"My dreams kept me up, too. The first one centered on Mara sacrificing her life. The second one was set in Grayskull City. I've never visited that city in the real world."

"Why did Mara sacrifice herself?"

"She wanted to save the world from being overrun by supernatural monsters. Mara jumped into a portal. It must have taken her somewhere, because there was no trace of her body afterwards. Horde Prime probably killed her."

"Mara's spirit could be stuck in the portal. Or perhaps the underworld, assuming she went there."

"That aside, I want to take a trip to Grayskull City at one point." Adora placed the cup into the sink. "Hopefully Adam is still living there."

"Is it okay if we go on the trip together?"

"Yes. Anyways, I'm going back to bed." Adora strode to the archway. "Good night."

"Night," Glimmer replied.

---

Several days later, the two women had packed their clothes and hauled their suitcases into the car. After they filled up the car with gas, they left Bright Moon City. While Glimmer was sleeping in the passenger seat, Adora was driving on the highway. Clouds blotted out the sunlight. At times, a driver would cut them off, making Adora swear under her breath. In the distance, mountain peaks rose into the sky. The vehicle moved past several blue signs displaying names of restaurants, gas stations, and hotels. An orange sign warned passing drivers of a road under construction. *Guess we'll run into traffic.* She glanced at the GPS for a quick second before looking ahead.

Ten minutes dragged on, and every car slowed down. Adora released an audible sigh, shaking her head. She took a small sip from her water bottle, careful not to drink too much at a time. Raindrops began pelting the car. Droplets slid down the window, forming narrow rivulets. As fifteen minutes passed by, the traffic continued at a snail's pace. The highway on the opposite side was moving faster. Eventually, the traffic began picking up the pace.

By lunchtime, Adora steered the car off the highway after seeing a sign with multiple restaurant logos. The first drive-thru had tons of cars lined up. At least there were other options. She chose the least busy one.

"Glimmer, do you want anything?" Adora asked as she steered the car toward a sign displaying the menu.

Glimmer yawned. "Yes." She squinted at the menu. "Veggie rolls."

"I'm getting the orange chicken."

The two women ordered the food and waited for the drivers in front of them to leave. Adora steered the vehicle to a small

window, retrieved a paper bag, and moved the car to a parking space. She took out a box and opened it, revealing the orange chicken. The delicious aroma wafted into her nose. Glimmer opened a box filled with veggie rolls and a small cup of soy sauce. Adora and Glimmer chowed down on lunch as they observed the street.

"I bet this comes with fortune cookies," Glimmer said as she rummaged through the paper bag.

"The messages inside can be silly," Adora replied, thinking of the times she had Chinese takeout that included fortune cookies.

Glimmer gathered a couple plastic bags containing fortune cookies, then handed one to Adora. The blonde opened the bag and broke the fortune cookie in half. The message said: "Don't walk alone in the dark." *Sounds cryptic.* Adora expected a funny saying. Instead, she had received a strange message.

"This one's cryptic," Adora said as she showed the narrow paper to Glimmer. "What do you think?"

"It sounds like the point of the suspense genre," Glimmer said. "Not to mention horror."

"What did yours say?"

"Mine said, 'ignore previous cookie.'"

"Is that it?"

"Yeah." Glimmer tossed the plastic bag and empty box into the paper bag. "There are more cookies, though."

---

"You saw her at the gas station just outside Bright Moon City?" Catra shouted as she glowered at Rogelio. "And you didn't catch her?"

The gang was in an abandoned warehouse, chatting. Catra couldn't ignore the fury rising within her chest. If it was strong enough, she would transform into a werepanther and go on a rampage. She paced back and forth. Her minions were useless, and they always tested her patience. Their excuses regarding Adora's friends didn't help matters at all. It wasn't as if the blonde depended on those people for protection.

"There was a girl with her. Dyed hair, short, and tan. If I had tried to get Adora, her companion would notice," Rogelio explained.

Catra threw her head back, laughing mirthlessly. "There's always something! We need to try harder."

Lonnie crossed her arms. "If they're not in Bright Moon City anymore, what's the point? Do we just sit around? We have things to worry about, like our gang."

Kyle approached the door. "Can I go?"

Catra scowled. "No. I don't care about your imaginary need for breaks! Okay, Rogelio... did Adora and her friend say anything about where they were going?"

Rogelio shrugged. "I asked them, but they wouldn't tell me. It's because of the insignia on my shirt."

"This isn't working."

Daisy rose her hand. "What isn't working?"

Catra pointed to the insignia on her jacket. "The symbol. People see it, they refuse to offer information. If Adora was in some sort of protection program, they might as well admit it." An idea formed in her mind. *Maybe I'll ask Shadow Weaver to use a location spell.*

"So, what should we do, boss?" Daisy asked.

"Does anyone here own a car? I'm going to Fright Zone City to speak with Shadow Weaver, a woman who raised Adora. She may know," Catra said. "The insignia needs to be concealed. Or, we could wear outfits that don't resemble our style."

"People are scared of us, so they won't give us anything."

Catra smirked. "We'll take the clothes, even if we don't pay any money for them."

---

By the time Glimmer and Adora arrived at a hotel, it was midnight. According to the online map, this place had good reviews. The guests had occupied most of the rooms, and the only option was a room with a single bed. Adora carried the suitcases into their room. Distant sounds of people talking and a single dog barking drifted into her ears. This place must have allowed pets. Hopefully the dog would stay quiet for the rest of the night. Light flooded the room as the two women set their suitcases on the desk.

"I think the walls are thin because we can hear sounds from other rooms," Glimmer said.

"The reviewers must have overlooked that detail," Adora replied. "Also, I'll sleep on the couch."

The two women changed into their pajamas and got ready to call it a night. Adora reclined on her bed, and the moment the lights were off, she closed her eyes. The air conditioner emitted a low hum. A scent of freshener lingered in the air. It took forever for her to fall asleep, as she kept dwelling on the trip. She tossed and turned for an hour. When exhaustion took hold, she drifted to dreamland.

...

*Adora was running through a forest, peeking over her shoulder from time to time. It was hard to tell who or what decided to chase her. A disembodied growl echoed in the darkness. Her racing heart pummeled her ribs. She fell forward and rolled onto*

*her back, then watched her pursuer approach. Moonlight pierced the forest ceiling. Catra stared down at her, wearing an evil smile.*

*"Hey, Adora..."*

*The greeting sent chills down Adora's spine. She was sure she had heard it before. "Just leave me alone."*

*Catra hissed as she stepped forward. "You left me. Abandoned me. And I'm taking you back."*

*Adora scooted backward until her spine met a tree. Catra crouched, then reached out a hand and touched her face. She slapped Catra's hand away from her cheek. The brunette transformed into a werepanther. As much as she wanted to flee, she was frozen to the spot.*

*The scenery flashed to a cavern. Adora had no idea how she winded up here. Despite the potential danger lurking in the shadows, she made her way through the tunnel. Footsteps followed her to a room. She whirled around. All she saw was a thick fog. Who was following her? A pale hand emerged, then pressed against her cheek. Green eyes glowed. She patted her shorts for a weapon, yet her pockets were empty.*

*"Who are you?" Adora asked.*

*The stranger's hand moved to Adora's neck and began tightening its grip. She attempted to break free, but this person's grip was too strong.*

*"I'll eliminate you. The previous hunter invaded my domain, and I executed her," a male voice said.*

...

Adora jolted awake, a shout trapped in her throat as she sat up, taking in her surroundings. Her hands jittered as she ran her fingers through her hair. Images from the nightmare lingered. The moment she saw a shadow lurking in the corner, she turned on

the lamp. She struggled to take in a deep breath. The shadow in the corner vanished. Even though she wasn't in any danger, her senses remained on high alert. Glimmer's tired voice interrupted her thoughts.

"Adora?" Glimmer murmured. "Is something wrong?"

"I had a nightmare," Adora said. "Catra was chasing me, and the dream changed when she transformed. Next thing I knew, I was in a cavern, and this person, or entity... whoever it was, he stalked me. he touched my face, and when he grabbed my neck..." Her voice trailed off. "He mentioned killing a previous hunter."

Glimmer scooted off her bed and proceeded to sit on Adora's. Then, she held Adora's hands, quelling their shaking. "You're here with me, safe and sound."

"I didn't mean to wake you up."

"It's okay. I figured you were having a nightmare, so..."

"Would you, um..." Warmth crept into Adora's cheeks. "Stay with me in bed? I'd rather have someone closer... just to keep the nightmares away."

Glimmer's cheeks reddened. "Sure." She turned off the lights.

Both women reclined in bed, figuring out their positions until they settled on facing each other. Their knees and feet met. The proximity was enough to make Adora's body feel warmer. Good thing they had the air conditioner. Within minutes, she fell asleep.

# Chapter 8

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

In the morning, Glimmer and Adora left the hotel and continued their journey to Grayskull City. They bought breakfast pastries and flavored coffee from a convenience store while the gas was filling up the car. According to the online map, they would arrive in Grayskull City around two or three, depending on traffic conditions. This time, Glimmer was driving the car. Adora played games on her phone. As fun as the apps were, the ads would interrupt the good parts. Sometimes they would pop up after completing a level. Like yesterday, they had to deal with rainy weather. The wipers seemed to move to the beat of the current song.

"How did you sleep?" Glimmer asked.

"I slept okay," Adora replied. She recalled sleeping in bed together.

"Good."

"After spending time in Grayskull City, I'll make sure Horde Prime never rises." Adora shuddered, remembering the nightmare. "The previous hunter he mentioned... I have a feeling he was referring to Mara. He might have killed her in the past, but I'm going to defeat him."

"You don't know how powerful he is."

"I've fought Hordak. Fought other vampires and demons. I'm sure I can handle Horde Prime."

Glimmer steered the car to the right, then passed a truck. "If I recall properly, I helped you a few times."

Adora turned her attention to the signs. "I know. But I don't want you to get killed while trying to protect me one day."

"For starters, you're a human, like Mara. The supernatural world can be dangerous. You might be good at fighting, but what will you do if an enemy overpowers you in battle?"

---

After visiting Shadow Weaver in Fright Zone City yesterday, Catra had left the city with important information... and her own car. She had told the gang to accompany her just in case. According to Shadow Weaver, Adora was on the way to Grayskull City. So, she drove the gang to a hotel. They had spent the night in separate rooms. If she ever saw Adora, she would drag her home. No matter how much the blonde would resist, they would be together again.

"So now, we're just chasing Adora?" Lonnie asked.

"I'll do whatever it takes," Catra said as she sped past a super-slow car.

"What would you do after you find her?"

"Return to Fright Zone City and stay there."

"Can the gang move to Fright Zone City."

Catra smirked. "As long as you don't betray the gang, you can come with me. If any of you choose to be a traitor, there will be fatal consequences." *I'll use my werepanther powers to tear someone's limbs apart.*

Kyle cleared his throat. "Can I use the restroom?"

"No. You can use the seat as a toilet."

"Sorry. Guess I'll piss my pants."

Catra chuckled. "You're so pitiful."

Daisy sighed. "Boss, are you gonna treat us like this?"

"Like what?"

"Refusing to let someone relieve themselves in a rest area until we reach our destination."

"Shut up."

"Okay, I'll keep my peace."

Catra hissed as she checked the rearview mirror. "Anyone else gonna say something?"

The rest of the passengers remained silent, eyes wide as they leaned back in their seats. Catra smirked. "Good. I don't need any unnecessary opposition. I didn't defeat Tung Lashor for nothing!"

---

Afternoon came. Glimmer and Adora arrived in Grayskull City. They reserved a room at a small motel by the downtown area, then visited a local restaurant. Adora looked up the documentary about the Glenn twins and tapped a picture of Adam. While waiting for someone to lead them to a table, Adora showed the picture to random strangers. Each individual said that they didn't know where Adam lived. Soon enough, her actions drew the attention of a redheaded woman. The woman seemed to be around her age.

"I know him," the woman said.

"You do?" Adora asked.

"Yes. And you look like him. Are you a relative?"

"I'm his twin. We were separated at five. My name's Adora."

The woman shook Adora's hand. "Teela."

"Glimmer and I were about to have an early dinner. If you want, you can join us, and we'll talk more."

Teela nodded. "I'll join you."

A waiter approached the three women. "Your table is ready. Are you having a girls' day out?"

Glimmer shook her head. "Adora and I were traveling together, and we met Teela just now."

"Oh. Come with me."

They strode to a table for three, then occupied the chairs. Tons of questions whizzed through Adora's mind, and she couldn't wait to ask Teela about Adam. The waiter returned with dinner rolls and glasses of water. She grabbed a roll, cut it in half, and slathered it with cinnamon butter. A distant sound of laughter mingled with the shouts of several children.

"What brings you here?" Teela asked, resting her toned arms on the table.

"I'm here to see my twin. After I saw that documentary, I decided to take a trip to Grayskull City," Adora explained.

"I've seen the documentary one time. It must have been awful, being separated from the only family member a person has left."

"The woman who adopted me had isolated me. She was a terrible guardian. Sad stuff aside, how did you know Adam?"

Teela wore a fond smile. "We went to school together. One night, during prom, he confessed his feelings, and we hit it off."

Adora picked up the menu. "So, where does he live?" An image of the jumbled address surfaced.

"He lives in the house you two grew up in. When he graduated from high school, he moved there just to feel closer to Marlena

and Randor Glenn."

"Have you ever found out who murdered them?"

"No."

Adora scrutinized the menu. "I'd like to know who did it, and why they would kill Mom and Dad." A memory of the boy from her dream arose. "I have some questions... Why did the people at the orphanage let me and Adam be separated? Why did Shadow Weaver forbid me from seeing Adam ever since?" Tears stung her eyes as she spoke.

Glimmer placed a hand onto Adora's shoulder. "Adora... you're going to see your brother today. You'll be happy to reunite with him after years of being apart. There is no Shadow Weaver to isolate you."

The three women ordered their dinner. As they waited for their meal, they discussed a variety of topics. At one point, Teela mentioned a vampire invading Adam's house. She had stopped the vampire from killing him. This made Adora ask if Teela was a hunter.

"I'm pretty sure Hope Light told me that a hunter works alone," Adora said.

"My mentor said something similar," Teela replied.

"How much experience did you have?"

"I've been doing it since high school."

"I became one after I moved to Bright Moon City. I may need more training, in case Horde Prime unleashes demons and other dark creatures from the underworld. A hunter from the 1800s, Mara, attempted to stop him, only to lose her life."

Teela arched her brow. "Where did you hear the story? Speaking of her, I once borrowed a book about Mara."

Adora shrugged. "Hope Light mentioned Mara. I had dreams about her. She has a friend named Serenia."

---

After dinner, Adora, Glimmer, and Teela went to Adam's house. Upon entering, Adora had another flashback from one of her dreams. The entryway was where her parents died. It felt strange being in here. She could have grown up in this home. Instead, she was robbed of a happy childhood. She turned her attention to the man who resembled her. For a moment, time froze. She stared into his eyes, then examined his features. He seemed as shocked as she felt.

"Adam..." Adora whispered, tears brimming in her eyes as she closed the distance between them. "I thought I would never see you again." She wrapped her arms around her brother.

"I couldn't believe this," Adam said.

"Me, either. But we saw each other again. After all those years..."

Adam extended a hand, moving his palm toward Adora's face. Adora pulled away, and he wore an apologetic expression. "Did I startle you?"

"A little. It's a habit I developed after growing up in an abusive environment," Adora said. "Not to mention dealing with a shitty ex. However, if I know someone or trust them well enough, I may allow them to touch me."

Adam gently wiped the tears off Adora's cheek. "I'm sorry you had to go through that." His fingers were warm to the touch.

Glimmer pointed to the door. "I'll grab the ouija board. Maybe your parents' ghosts are haunting your home. You two can catch up on all those lost years."

"I haven't seen their ghosts yet," Adam told Glimmer as she left the house.

Teela crossed her arms. "There are signs of a haunting, though. Flickering lights, disembodied voices, objects moving by themselves... the list goes on."

"I'm aware of the unexplained occurrences."

While Teela and Adam were talking, Adora ascended the stairs. There was something familiar about this house. Suppressed memories surfaced, occupying her mind as she stepped into an empty room. An image of a dresser sitting between two small beds flashed into her mind. The colors were gender-neutral, and toys used to clutter the floor. As she strode toward the window, the temperature dropped.

"Adora..."

Adora whirled around. No one was here. A feminine silhouette lingered by the door, accompanied by a flowery scent. The entity vanished as soon as it appeared. She made her way to the stairs. Glimmer was already in the entryway, carrying the ouija board. Descending the stairs, she observed her surroundings. Assuming that the disembodied voice belonged to her mother, did Marlena know who she was? She walked into the living room, where Glimmer took the ouija board. Teela and Adam plopped onto the couch, watching as Glimmer set a planchette onto the ouija board.

"Marlena Glenn... Randor Glenn... are you here?" Glimmer asked.

The planchette began moving on its own, pointing to a few letters. Glimmer continued, "Do you know who killed you?"

Silence penetrated the air. Adora detected the same spirit from before. This time, a man accompanied the woman. They wore unreadable expressions, yet she saw a lack of hostility in their body language. Once again, the planchette glided across the ouija board, while Glimmer wrote down each letter.

"Why did the demon attack you?" Glimmer asked.

"A demon?" Adam and Adora exclaimed in unison.

Glimmer lifted a finger to her lips. "You don't need to interrupt. Also, please stay calm."

"Sorry. It wasn't my intention," Adora said. "The reveal shocked me. Anyways, go ahead."

Glimmer turned her attention back to the ouija board. "Marlena and Randor, can you answer my question regarding the attack?"

The planchette pointed to a variety of letters. Glimmer finished taking notes, then said, "So, the demon killed Marlena and Randor because Horde Prime wanted one of his minions to attack those in Mara's lineage. Adora and Adam... Horde Prime wants you dead."

"Adam and I are related to Mara?" Adora asked. "Also, how did Horde Prime know of her lineage?"

"His minions might have disguised themselves as humans just to report to him regarding Mara's bloodline. Before she sacrificed herself, she had a child. After Mara's demise, Serenia began raising the child," Teela said.

"Someone must have kept track of our ancestry," Adam said. "I wonder why Horde Prime's minions didn't go after Mara's child."

"It's because Serenia wanted to take the child to a safe place."

---

Night surrounded the land. Adora and Glimmer went to the motel and entered their room. As she sat on the bed, she replayed the day in her mind. Horde Prime must have waited for years to make his move. He had the audacity to send the demon to Marlena and Randor. Glimmer sat next to the blonde.

"Are you okay?" Glimmer asked.

"Yes. It's a lot to take in," Adora replied. "I'm happy to have met Adam. And a little sad to know that my parents are dead. Also, the lineage thing..."

"Do you want to spend another day in Grayskull City?"

"Yes. Actually, I'm not sure."

"Why are you unsure? After all, you reunited with Adam. You deserved some closure."

"Horde Prime has to be stopped." Adora looked up. "I can't let him or his cronies kill anyone else." She sighed as she strode to the door. "I need some fresh air."

"You're going out alone?" Glimmer asked. "Other than Adam and Teela, we don't know anyone around here. Someone could-"

"I'll be right back. Don't worry, okay?" Adora replied.

"I'm still gonna worry. Adora, I..." Glimmer's voice trailed off, a blush blooming on her cheeks as she looked away. "Never mind. Be careful."

Adora stepped outside, shutting the door behind her. The cool night air enveloped her as she wandered across the parking lot. She was aware of the dangers of being a hunter. So far, however, she was alive. Yet she wasn't sure if she would survive fighting Horde Prime. She didn't want to wind up like Mara, as she had an entire life ahead of her. There were things she hadn't done yet. If she didn't do anything about Horde Prime, more people would die. A car moved onto the parking lot. Once it occupied an empty parking space, several individuals emerged. The streetlamps exposed their faces. And their gazes were fixated on her.

"Is this Adora?" One of them asked.

The car door opened, and a familiar woman stepped out. Adora didn't have the dagger with her this time. Catra approached. So did the others. Adora widened her stance and balled her hands into fists, keeping a close eye on Catra.

"Have you been following us?" Adora asked.

"Yes. I told Shadow Weaver to use a tracking spell. You're coming with me," Catra said.

Adora swung a fist. Catra caught her wrist before she could deck her. Then, she launched an uppercut at the brunette's jaw and connected, prompting her ex to release her. She drove her foot into Catra's abdomen. One of Catra's companions slipped behind the blonde and grabbed her. As she struggled to break free, her captor placed a cloth onto her nose and mouth. She inhaled its toxic smell. Dark spots blurred her vision.

"I have you now, Adora," Catra said.

Chapter End Notes

Twitter handle: @xAdore_thatx
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# Chapter 9

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Glimmer checked the clock as she waited for Adora to return. Something didn't feel right about this situation. She left the hotel room and searched the parking lot for the blonde. Where did Adora go? She glanced around. Panic began filling her heart. If something were to happen to Adora... Shaking her head, she dialed her friend's number and waited for Adora to answer. *Come on, come on, come on...* She paced back and forth, swearing under her breath. After fifteen long minutes, the phone rang. Pressing the screen against her ear, she anticipated the sound of her friend's voice. Instead, she heard a voice that belonged to someone else. *Oh, no.*

"If you're looking for Adora... she can't answer the phone," the voice said.

"Who are you?" Glimmer demanded. "Where is Adora?"

"I'm Catra."

*Fuck. I should have been watching Adora, not letting her leave the hotel room!* Glimmer tightened her grip on the phone. "What are you going to do to her? Tell me where you're taking her." She swore she heard muffled screaming in the background. "Did you kidnap her?" Anger replaced panic. "Catra, I swear if you lay a hand on her, I'll make you regret it! Why are you so obsessed with her? She left you because you abused her!"

"As usual, she says things that aren't true," Catra said.

"Then why did she leave Fright Zone City? Why did she have nightmares?" At this point, Glimmer didn't care if people heard her shouting. "By kidnapping Adora, you pissed me off!"

"If you were so serious about protecting her, why weren't you with her?"

"Don't play games."

"I would like to continue the conversation all night, but my hands are full."

The muffled screams continued, followed by objects bumping. It sounded as if Adora was trying to escape. Suddenly, the phone hung up. Glimmer clutched her hair, breathing heavily as she raced to the hotel room and slammed the door behind her. Was Catra hurting Adora? She tossed everything into the suitcases. Even Adora's dagger. She didn't care if she were to drive all night. After she threw the suitcases into the trunk, she called the front desk number and cancelled her stay.

---

Adora rammed her entire weight against the door. It didn't budge. Catra must have thought it funny to leave her in the trunk. A stench of cigarette and alcohol overwhelmed her nostrils. She didn't want this to happen. Forcing herself to rise, she peeked out the window. It hadn't taken long for the brunette to drive the vehicle out of Grayskull City. If she could somehow climb out the window... No, she would have to wait, because the car was moving. Or should she risk getting hurt just to escape? Aware of the duct tape restraining her wrists behind her back, she searched the trunk for anything that could break the tape. Any sharp object would work.

"Adora, what are you doing back there?" Catra shouted.

If not for the duct tape on Adora's mouth, she would be able to speak. She slid to the car floor. It might be better to be subtle about a future escape attempt. However, with Catra's gang being present, she might not succeed. Her thoughts drifted to Glimmer. Did Glimmer notice that she was gone? Would the shorter woman take action? She should have stayed in the hotel room instead of going outside and letting herself get captured.

"Have you given up?" Catra asked.

Adora emitted a muffled scream.

"I thought you did," Catra continued. "I'm not stopping the car anytime."

*So much for my idea.*

"You left me for another girl. She'll do anything to take you back. Well, I'm not letting you go," Catra said.

"MMMHHHH! MMMMMHHHH!"

A woman cleared her throat. "Catra, can't you make her quiet?"

Catra chuckled. "No. Her voice will keep me awake all night. We'll get to Fright Zone City faster if I remain alert."

"It's annoying to listen to."

Catra snorted. "Whatever, Daisy."

---

A day after driving home, Glimmer had gotten some rest. She had expected the trip to be smooth. Instead, everything went down the drain when Catra showed up and abducted Adora. She summoned a location spell. According to the spell, Adora was in an abandoned warehouse. If she stormed that place, she would sock Catra. Rushing to her car, she entered the vehicle and drove out of the neighborhood. As she steered the vehicle into the main street, a red light hindered her. A frustrated groan escaped her lips. Cars sped back and forth in front of her as she waited for the green light. Her patience was wearing thin. Adora needed her, and she couldn't afford to waste any time! What if something horrible happened?

The green light replaced the red, allowing Glimmer to proceed. She moved toward the highway. Nothing would prevent her from finding Adora and bringing her back home. Hurrying down the

highway, she stared straight ahead. A memory of her last conversation with Adora surfaced. She had been prepared to confess her feelings, only to become nervous. Would there ever be a good time, though?

Glimmer's gaze landed on a sign. It said: "Road work ahead." If she ran into super slow traffic, she would lose her cool. She swore under her breath. Twenty minutes dragged on, and the vehicles slowed down.

"Are you kidding me?" Glimmer shouted. "Traffic is the worst!"

---

Adora's face was still stinging from the removal of duct tape. Catra had locked her in a room and bound her to a chair. Despite a lack of sleep, her senses were on high alert. Footsteps shuffled past the door. A faint smell of dried blood lingered. The door swung open, and Catra walked in. Fury darkened the brunette's mismatched eyes. If her limbs weren't restricted, she would flee.

"What did you see in that girl?" Catra asked as she stepped closer.

"She was kind, unlike you," Adora said.

Catra slapped Adora's face. "I can't believe you let her worm her way into your heart!" She drew back a fist. "You owe me a fucking apology for abandoning me!"

"No. You tormented me when we were dating. You're the one who owes me an apology."

Catra swung her fist at Adora's cheekbone and connected. "Since when did I torment you? You're misremembering things." She inched closer, their faces mere inches apart.

Adora spat into Catra's face, prompting the brunette to step back and look away. She watched her captor's body language, anticipating an aggressive reaction. Catra wiped the spit away, letting out a hiss. Once again, mismatched eyes glowered into her bright blues.

"You're unbelievable," Catra said.

"You got into my face," Adora replied. "It wasn't necessary."

Catra fell to the floor, panting as her body vibrated. She began transforming into a werepanther. By the time the transformation was complete, she stood on her hind legs, towering over Adora. A growl erupted from her snout.

Adora struggled against the restraints in a vain attempt to break free. "Catra, leave me alone."

Catra swiped at Adora's abdomen, digging through the shirt and into her flesh. A pool of blood stained Adora's shirt. She expected the werepanther to continue the attack. Instead, the beast stormed out of the room. A faint chime of a phone reached her ears. *My phone's ringtone.* Who was calling her? Glimmer? What was her friend doing at the moment? A part of her wondered if Glimmer would come here.

Lonnie entered the room, carrying Adora's phone. "Guess your friend wants to talk to you." She stepped forward and held out the phone near Adora's face.

"Lonnie, are you gonna try anything?" Adora asked.

A familiar voice spoke through the phone. "Adora, are you there? I'm coming to rescue you."

"Glimmer? Where are you now?" She replied.

"On the way."

Adora glared at Lonnie. "Lonnie, unbind my wrists so I can hold my phone."

Lonnie shook her head. "You'll attempt to escape. Catra will be mad if you do."

"Did you see her in werepanther form? She's dangerous."

"It doesn't matter." Lonnie strode to the door. "She's our leader."

Once Lonnie was gone, a skinny blonde guy visited the room. He wore a nervous expression. A part of Adora felt bad for him. What made him join the gang? Did someone compel him into joining? He didn't seem as hostile as the others. Still, she wouldn't trust anyone who was in a gang.

"What brought you here?" Adora asked.

"Just checking on the prisoner," the man said. "I'm Kyle."

"If you're thinking about exchanging pleasantries... Forget it." An idea popped into Adora's mind. "I need to use the restroom." *If my limbs are unbound, I will get out of here.*

"Okay... sure. I hope you're not tricking us," Kyle said as he removed the restraints.

Adora stood, then grabbed Kyle's shoulders and forced him to sit in the chair. After binding his wrists and ankles, she raced into an adjacent hallway. As soon as she descended the stairs, footsteps approached. She ducked behind a metal column, heart pounding as she observed her surroundings. Taking in deep breaths, she glanced at the doors and windows. A door closed, prompting her to peek out from her hiding spot. The coast was clear. As her foot bumped an object, she glanced at the floor and saw a metal bat. Retrieving the bat, she made her way to the window. She rammed the bat into the glass, shattering it into a million pieces.

"Hey!" A voice shouted.

Adora whirled around. Lonnie leaned against the doorframe, scowling. Tightening her grip on the bat, she kept a close eye on Lonnie's body language.

"How did you-" Lonnie began. "Wait. Did you pull a trick on a gang member?" She took out a taser and charged at Adora.

Adora evaded the attack. "Do you and your friends want to know what happens if you don't leave me alone?"

As Lonnie lunged, Adora swung the bat and connected. The dark-skinned woman fell to the floor, unconscious. A combination of voices drifted into her ears, accompanied by footsteps. She climbed out the window and landed into the bushes. Thorns pricked her exposed skin as she pushed the shrubbery aside and dashed across the lawn. Adrenaline pumped through her veins as she approached the street.

A realization dawned on Adora. She forgot her phone! How would she tell Glimmer that she was okay? It wouldn't be safe to return to the warehouse and get her phone. What if Catra was still in there, waiting for her? Without the dagger, she wouldn't stand a chance against Catra's werepanther form.

"She's getting away!" A male voice shouted.

"We better hurry, Rogelio!" Daisy replied.

Adora glanced over her shoulder, and sure enough, the two gangsters were catching up. They carried tasers in their hands. Either she could fight them off, or she could elude them. The former could result in a taser catching her off-guard. The latter might result in running to an alley, where there could be more criminals lurking. Fright Zone City's alleys were notorious for muggings, assault, and even murder. One time during her teen years, she had been in one of those alleys. This city truly lived up to its name.

Adora swung the bat at Daisy and missed. Then, she aimed for Rogelio's head, and he ducked. After several tries, she knocked them out. She began running down the sidewalk, despite the ache in her abdomen. A part of her was surprised that Catra didn't pursue her at any point. Ten minutes whizzed by as she raced past the skyscrapers. Exhaustion slowed her down as she approached a bench and sat. A man in dishevelled clothes

plopped onto the bench and placed his hand onto her knee. She winced at the touch.

"Are you alone?" The man asked.

"Get away from me," Adora said. "I don't know you!" She shoved the man's hand away and rose to her height.

Mr. Creep grabbed Adora's wrist and yanked her onto the bench. "Sounds like someone's playing hard to get."

Adora smacked the man's face, catching him off-guard. She hurried toward the opposite side of the street. If she had stayed on the bench any longer, he would have assaulted her. Would she ever have a moment to herself? There was no one to trust in this city. Walking across the sidewalk, she scrutinized the traffic for Glimmer's car. There was no sign of the vehicle.

---

Glimmer had finally arrived in Fright Zone City, navigating more traffic. She used the location spell again, just to be sure. This time, however, Adora was on a sidewalk, wandering around. The traffic picked up the pace, allowing her to drive faster. How did Adora flee the abandoned warehouse? Did the blonde outsmart Catra somehow? She steered the car to the right, then checked the rearview and side-view mirrors.

Glimmer spied a familiar blonde lingering on the sidewalk and parked her car. Adora dropped a metal bat and entered the car. It didn't take long for Glimmer to notice the pool of blood on Adora's abdomen. What happened? Did Catra hurt the taller woman?

"I escaped. But I lost my phone," Adora said. "You came for me. I was looking all over the place for your car. In case you were wondering about the blood, Catra turned into a werepanther and scratched me. All because I told her not to get in my face. Afterwards, I tricked one of her minions into letting me flee."

"I'm glad you're alive. I should have accompanied you at that motel, instead of allowing you to get kidnapped."

"Don't blame yourself." Adora held Glimmer's hand. "It's not your fault. If I had listened-"

"Adora, it's not your fault, either. If someone is to blame, it's Catra. I still want to deck her." Glimmer steered the car into the street. "Let's go home."

Chapter End Notes

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# Chapter 10

Three weeks had passed since the rescue. One day, Glimmer had just finished bandaging Adora's abdomen. The wound was getting better, although it might wind up being a scar. However, Adora's emotional wounds would take longer to heal. The blonde's nightmares had increased in frequency, often waking her up at night. Whenever she was out and about, she would be on constant alert, never letting her guard down. As a result of her stress, dark circles had formed under her eyes.

Would a trip to Mystacor help? Mystacor had a hot springs resort with relaxing background music. Maybe it could help Adora relax. Glimmer closed the first aid kit, then plopped onto the couch.

"How do you feel about going to Mystacor?" Glimmer suggested.

"Mystacor?" Adora repeated.

"The town has a hot springs resort, named the Steam Grotto. It has calming music."

Adora sighed. "I can't relax. I have to be alert."

"Adora..."

"Last time I let my guard down, something bad happened." Adora crossed her arms, frowning. "According to Hope Light, I was supposed to be this strong, badass hunter who slays monsters. Instead, I had been a damsel in distress. I shouldn't be a weak victim."

Glimmer held Adora's hands. "You are not weak. You have slayed dark creatures multiple times, no matter how dangerous they were. Also, you survived an abusive childhood and a horrible relationship. I'm sure it took courage to leave a toxic environment."

"I was scared when I left Catra."

"Well, you didn't let fear stop you."

"If I'm not weak, what am I?"

Glimmer smiled. "You're a brave and kind person."

Adora's cheeks reddened. "I am?"

"Yes."

"Is Catra gonna come back, though?"

"She hasn't bothered us in a while, so I don't think she will. At least for the time being." Anger bloomed in Glimmer's chest as she mentioned Catra. "I hope she stays away forever. As for her cronies, I heard news of them returning to Bright Moon City and getting arrested." She took in a deep breath. "They deserved imprisonment for aiding her. Anyways... I'm still considering visiting the Steam Grotto in Mystacor. And I want you to come with me. You've been stressed lately, and it's not good for you, because you were tense and had nightmares every night."

"Glim, I'm fine," Adora said.

"No, you're not. All those nightmares you had, they were the results of your trauma. Being abused and getting kidnapped clearly affected you."

"Okay, okay! I get it. If it makes you happy, I'll go to the Steam Grotto with you."

Glimmer rose. "Alright. Let's get our swimsuits and go."

---

When Glimmer and Adora visited the Steam Grotto in Mystacor, they changed into their swimsuits. The hot springs resort wasn't busy, so it should be peaceful. Glimmer led Adora toward a small, steaming pool in the ground. Before entering the water, they took off their shoes. Despite the swimsuit covering Adora's back and abdomen, she felt exposed. She sunk her toes into the water, then

pulled her foot away. Glimmer grabbed her hands and led her into the pool.

"Focus on relaxing. Let all your worries melt away," Glimmer said as the two women sat.

"Okay. Sure," Adora replied.

"Just breathe."

Adora leaned against the rock wall, inhaling the scent of steaming water. The heat enveloped her body, and a yawn escaped her lips. Her eyelids grew heavy, and she fought the urge to fall asleep. The nightmares could be waiting for her in dreamland, manifestations of her worst fears ready to plague her slumber. Time dragged on as she continued resisting the pull into dreamland. At one point, Glimmer wrapped her arms around Adora's waist.

Glimmer's hair tickled Adora's chin. She glanced down at the shorter woman, smiling. It was nice to have a friend who cared about her. The spellcaster had a tendency to be touchy-feely. But she didn't mind, as those touches were always gentle. Closing her eyes, she drifted into the realm of sleep...

...

*Adora's eyes fluttered open. Glimmer wasn't here. Her friend must have left to go to the restroom. She stepped out of the pool and wrapped a towel around herself. A feeling of being watched sent a chill up and down her spine. Shadows lurked in the corners of the room. She began walking toward the restroom, but she was slower than usual. This place was eerily quiet, as if someone muted the world and forgot to turn the sound back on. She blinked, then found herself in the restroom, looking at the stalls. No sign of Glimmer. Did her friend leave? As she made her way out of the restroom, she saw nothing but darkness.*

*"Glimmer? Where are you?" Adora asked, despite her lips not moving.*

*Adora closed her eyes, unable to fight the heaviness in her eyelids.*

...

*Adora woke up. This time, she was in her bed. How did she get here? Did she fall asleep in the pool? Maybe Glimmer drove her all the way home and tucked her in bed. She swung her legs over the edge of the bed. Pain flooded her abdomen, as if Catra scratched her. She shuffled into the hallway, trembling as she made her way to the stairs. Wait. Where was Glimmer? An impenetrable darkness awaited her at the bottom of the stairs. Glowing eyes looked up at her. What were they? Demons? Supernatural creatures? She patted her pockets, only to find nothing. Perhaps she should go to her room and get the dagger. As she turned around, what she saw froze her to the spot. A familiar silhouette of a werepanther towered over her.*

*"How did you get in here?" Adora murmured.*

...

*Adora's eyes fluttered open. She was on the couch. A heaviness blanketed her body as she sat up. The hot springs must have made her sleepy. Listening to her breathing and tapping her foot, she made sure she was awake. Still, she couldn't shake off the feeling of being trapped. A muffled voice repeated her name. Yet no one else was in the living room.*

...

Adora awakened. This time, she thought she was still dreaming. Her senses rushed back to her, and she opened her eyes. Glimmer's violet eyes stared into her bright blues. Her friend was here the whole time while she was stuck in the dream. Well, more like several. For a moment, she expected to wake up in yet another dream.

"Did you have another nightmare?" Glimmer asked.

"I wouldn't call it a nightmare. It's a type of dream where I think I'm awake, only to be proven wrong several times," Adora replied. "It can be confusing."

"You were mumbling in your sleep. A few times, you said my name."

"It started with not knowing where you must have gone." Adora proceeded to describe the events that took place in her false awakenings.

"It does sound confusing," Glimmer said once Adora finished speaking. "Some parts were a little spooky."

Adora and Glimmer left the pool and put on their shoes, then changed their clothes and made their way out of the Steam Grotto. After entering their car, Glimmer steered the vehicle toward the street. Mystacor was smaller than the surrounding cities. The vehicle moved past antique shops, small restaurants, and duplexes. There wasn't a lot to do, other than visiting the lake. Glimmer drove to the lake and parked by the grass.

"Not a lot of people come here," Glimmer said as they strode toward the water. "It's peaceful. Sometimes Mermista swims in the lake." She placed two towels onto the shore.

Adora gazed at a person sitting on the deck. The individual seemed to be talking to someone. "Who are they talking to?"

"You mean Sea Hawk? He's probably chatting with Mermista."

A dark-skinned woman with braided hair emerged in front of the deck. Glimmer led Adora to the deck, then waved at the duo. "Hello, Mermista and Sea Hawk."

Sea Hawk stood, then turned around. "Hey. What have you been up to?" He glanced at Adora. "Are you two dating?"

Glimmer chuckled. "Adora and I were slaying monsters as usual. And no, we're close friends."

Mermista pushed herself free of the pond. A pair of legs replaced her dark blue tail. "She's a little cute, though. Anyways, how are Bow and Perfuma? Sea Hawk and I haven't seen them in a while."

"They're fine."

Once the conversation ended, Adora and Glimmer strode to their towels and reclined on the ground. She gazed at the clouds as they glided across the sky. Clasping her hands over her abdomen, she slowed her breathing. Seagulls flew in circles, cawing. She peeked at Glimmer. It was hard to ignore the soft and peaceful smile on the shorter woman's face. Adora furrowed her brows and rolled her tense shoulders. Not content with being still, she turned to one side. So far, she couldn't bring herself to relax. Why wasn't it working?

Rolling onto her back, Adora emitted a frustrated groan. A quick look at her friend told her that Glimmer wasn't relaxing. Both women sat up, and Glimmer made eye contact.

"I may have to book a therapy session," Adora said. "Do you know of any affordable options?"

"There's a few," Glimmer said. "Therapy may help you recover from your trauma."

"Yeah. Well, there's one problem. A therapist would think I'm crazy if I mention the supernatural stuff."

"You could leave out the supernatural parts."

Adora shrugged. "I would have to come up with something if a dark creature attacks humans while I'm attending therapy."

"I'll fight monsters," Glimmer said. "I'm a witch, remember?"

---

Ever since the two women had taken a trip to Mystacor, Adora booked several sessions with a therapist. The therapist suggested journaling, spending time with positive influences, and building

resilience. She had bought a journal, and wrote down an entry whenever she had the time. It felt good to let it all out in her journal. As the weeks became cooler, her nightmares showed up less often. She and Glimmer became closer, taking it slow as time passed. So far, there were no red flags.

One night, Adora and Glimmer patrolled a cemetery. Rows of headstones stretched from one side of the cemetery to the other. Moonlight illuminated the grays and whites of the headstones. Marble statues lingered under willow trees.

"Did you see anything suspicious?" Glimmer asked.

"No," Adora replied as she scrutinized the wrought iron fence. A pair of gleaming eyes watched them.

Those eyes were mismatched. Like a certain individual's. Adora had no desire to say that person's name. *Stop being afraid. You're stronger now, so don't freeze up.* Exhaling audibly, she pulled out a dagger. Cold air snaked into her jacket, despite its warmth. The mismatched eyes blinked. She pointed her flashlight at the mysterious creature, its light exposing an all-too-familiar face An icy claw of fear gripped her heart. Flashes of Catra's abusive behavior and the kidnapping flooded her mind. *So much for making progress.*

"Are you okay?" Glimmer asked. It didn't take long for her to notice what Adora saw. "Not again..." She took out a wolfsbane potion and chucked it toward Catra. The werepanther collapsed to the ground, unmoving.

"Why did she come back?" Adora asked.

"Second question... why didn't she put up a fight?"

"I thought she was here to hurt us some more."

"Same. We've got to restrain her before she mauls innocent people."

"And what would you do once she wakes up?"

Glimmer strode to the fence. "I'll interrogate her."

Adora shook her head. "It's a bad idea. She'll attack."

"If she tries, I'll knock her out with the wolfsbane potion." Glimmer levitated the werepanther into the air. "She's going into the catacombs. We'll come back in the morning."

# Chapter 11

In the morning, Adora and Glimmer returned to the cemetery and entered the catacombs. They stepped into a room with stone flooring and skull arches. Catra was no longer in werepanther form. The brunette stirred awake, then stood, mismatched eyes glowering at Adora. Standing tall, the blonde took in deep breaths and approached. She made sure to keep her distance, as she had a feeling Catra would lash out. Indicators of hostility were clear; rigid cords in the neck, bared teeth, and angry eyebrows. Glimmer stepped toward Adora, ready to protect her from Catra.

"You chained me up?" Catra shouted.

"Yes. What brought you here?" Adora asked.

"Shadow Weaver and Hordak-"

"They made you come?"

"No. They joined forces to help Horde Prime unleash supernatural creatures from the underworld. You're going to lose, as you'll be too scared and weak to fight."

Adora clenched her jaw. "I'll stop Horde Prime, Shadow Weaver, and Hordak."

Catra threw her head back, laughing. "That's rich, coming from the girl who allowed my gang to capture her!"

"I'm the same girl who escaped the warehouse." Adora shoved her fists into her pockets. "Don't act as if Horde Prime will improve the world. He and his cronies would turn the world into a nightmare if he succeeds. Anyways..." She sighed. "Why were you so cruel?"

"Because you left me!" Catra retorted.

"You abused me before the break-up."

"I get it. No one wants me. The friends I made after leaving the orphanage, they abandoned me when I graduated from high school. You tried to leave me several times, and one day... you did. I didn't want to be left alone. How would you feel if you lived in an orphanage, and no one had the heart to adopt you? It's as if people somehow see the beast in me. They always choose the normal kid."

"Being raised in an abusive home is just as awful. But I chose to be kind." Adora looked away. "There was a time when I believed my kindness would change your heart. Yet you hurt me." She crossed her arms. "I know you had a traumatic childhood in the orphanage, but it doesn't excuse your actions."

"So, are you going to keep me chained up?"

"Maybe," Adora said. "I mean, you've been horrible to me."

Glimmer cleared her throat. "Catra, when are Shadow Weaver, Hordak, and Horde Prime releasing the supernatural monsters from the underworld?"

Catra scowled. "As soon as possible. The Horde clan will defeat the Rebellion clan. What are you going to do about it? Humans will be under the Horde clan's command."

"At least you revealed their plans to us. We won't let the Horde clan hurt the human race."

"You're so determined. What will you do if big bad Prime shows up?"

Adora shook her head. "Catra, we're done talking."

---

Later on, Adora and Glimmer went home. She plopped onto the couch, massaging her temples. Although she had tried not to let Catra's words get to her, a part of her wondered if the werepanther had a point. Glimmer had helped her vanquish supernatural monsters a few times. Sure, she knew how to fight.

But she had allowed fear to overcome her sometimes. If she couldn't do better, she wouldn't be able to save the world.

*"You'll be too scared and weak to fight."*

Adora needed to train more, to suppress her fears, and to work alone. And what was she doing instead? Working on her trauma and depending on others to help her. She rose to her height and headed to the exercise room. Then, she removed her jacket and slipped on a pair of boxing gloves. No warm-ups or stretches. Just training. If she wanted to win, she couldn't afford to freeze up and lose. She clobbered the boxing dummy, delivering a variety of blows and pretending to duck incoming attacks.

*"I'll eliminate you."*

Sweat poured down Adora's face as she continued punching the dummy. It didn't take long for her to begin swinging her fists in a much quicker motion, not caring about controlling her movements. It didn't matter if she pulled a muscle or two. She fixated on her training, not allowing herself to be distracted. Her pulse raced as she panted. She kicked the dummy as hard as possible. Then, she repeated the movement many times. The door creaked open, interrupting her thoughts as she whirled around. Glimmer stood in the doorway, observing her.

"You were quiet on the way home. Is something wrong?" Glimmer asked.

"No. I have to be ready for when Horde Prime rises," Adora said. "I don't want to be too scared and weak to fight."

"Sounds like Catra struck a nerve with those words."

Adora took off her boxing gloves. "I could fail as a hunter. Hordak and Shadow Weaver could be working with Horde Prime, and who knows how dangerous they'll be if the three of them are together? Also, it could get a lot worse if supernatural monsters emerge from the underworld! I may have to sacrifice myself, as Mara once did."

"Adora, we're in this together." Glimmer closed the distance between the two women, then held Adora's hands. "We're not going to let them win. And there's no need for you to throw your life away."

"How can you be sure?"

"Because I have magic." Glimmer smiled. "And you're good at fighting."

Adora shrugged. "Yeah, but we still have to come up with a plan that doesn't involve one of us dying. I don't think we can just rush in and throw punches. Shadow Weaver is an experienced spellcaster. Hordak is a strong vampire. And Horde Prime, well, I don't know what his power is. Whatever it is, he must have used it to kill Mara."

"You have a point. However-"

"We have to figure out their weaknesses."

"Or I could just use a vanquishing spell."

"Shadow Weaver could outsmart you, or worse, drain your magic."

Glimmer smirked. "I could always deck her. There will be payback for the way she treated you."

"I don't want you to get hurt," Adora said. Just then, her phone chimed. "Someone messaged me." She took the phone out of her pocket.

**12:03**
**Adam:** Teela and I were at a hotel in Bright Moon City this morning. A demon came into our room and attacked her.

**Adora:** Is she okay? Also, I didn't know you were in Bright Moon City. Were you planning some sort of surprise visit?

**Adam:** She's okay, just badly injured. I came to this city to visit you. Right now, I have to be with Teela.

**12:04**
**Adora:** I'll find the demon.

Adora turned off the phone. "Glimmer, we're tracking down a demon. It attacked Teela while she and Adam were staying at a hotel."

Glimmer nodded. "I'll cast a location spell first."

---

According to the location spell, the demon was in a storage basement below the hotel. Tons of crates idled in the corners, covered in cobwebs and coated with a thick layer of dust. Adora and Glimmer searched the basement for any signs of the demon. The lights were dim, so they had to use flashlights to investigate dark corners. Footsteps approached them from behind, prompting them to whirl around. Adora drew her dagger, while Glimmer took out a potion. The demon sported a vertical scar on their face, and their eyes held no color. Like those bald, shriveled vampires Adora had encountered in the past, this one had a gaunt face.

"Hunters must die. Horde Prime will help his followers defeat the Rebellion clan," the demon said in a guttural voice.

"You know I'm a hunter?" Adora asked.

"Word travels fast. Brother Hordak has met you in the past. Your companion stopped him, did she not?" The demon released a sinister chuckle. "Horde Prime has plans for you."

"What plans?"

"If you continue hindering the Horde clan, Prime will confront you. He will crush you as he once destroyed Mara. I ran into a man who resembled you, and his girlfriend intervened. She deserved what was coming to her."

A chill stampeded up and down Adora's spine. "Horde Prime won't prevail. He never will!" She aimed the dagger toward the demon's chest, but the monster grabbed her wrist before she could slash him.

A sphere of electricity formed on the demon's free hand. "You're in for a fatal shock."

Adora pounded the demon's arm and kicked their groin, then broke free. "No. Glimmer and I will avenge Teela."

The demon launched the sphere of electricity at Adora, but she jumped out of the way before it hit her. She tossed the dagger at her enemy, watching the blade plunge into their side. Glimmer chucked the potion forward. The vial shattered, emitting a cloud of smoke around the demon while she repeated an incantation. Within seconds, the monster vanished.

---

Catra hated being stuck in one place. Especially if those chains were restraining her. Glimmer and Adora probably thought that it was a perfect punishment. Emitting a growl, she attempted to summon the beast within. Yet her werepanther form didn't surface. Did that purple-haired girl put something into the wolfsbane potion? Footsteps walked into the room. *It better not be them.* Looking up, she let out a snarl. *Shadow Weaver?* The pale woman wore a black dress, making her resemble a stereotypical wicked witch.

"You could have brought Adora to me," Shadow Weaver said. "However, considering the stories of her being a hunter and opposing the Horde clan..."

"Face it, bitch. She's running around with the angry potion-throwing girl who thinks she's big and tough despite being short," Catra replied.

"I will not accept your interruption!" The temperature dipped as Shadow Weaver rose her voice. "Anyways, I consider Adora a lost

cause. It's your fault. You were never a good influence on her."

Now Catra wanted to activate the beast within her. If only her powers weren't blocked. She glared at Shadow Weaver, gritting her teeth. The woman had been cold to her in the past, all because she and Adora were friends. When Catra and Adora used to date, it made Shadow Weaver angry.

"Hey, at least Adora and I aren't dating," Catra said. "You should be happy now."

"You're wrong. I won't be content until Adora stops defying me," Shadow Weaver said.

"Shouldn't you be more focused on helping Hordak and Horde Prime?"

"I'll make sure Adora doesn't stop Horde Prime from achieving his goals."

# Chapter 12

Chapter Notes

This chapter and the next chapter will be a little shorter.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

On the way home, Glimmer and Adora had grabbed some drinks from a coffee shop. They strode into the kitchen and sat. Glimmer couldn't help but notice the worry in Adora's bright blue eyes. She held Adora's hand, her thumb caressing the taller woman's knuckles. Ever since the news Catra gave them this morning, Adora had been tense. All she wanted to do was make the blonde feel better.

"I can't be idle while more people get hurt," Adora said as she carried her empty cup to the trash can. "I have to do something." She began pacing back and forth. "What did Hope Light even see in me, other than being Mara's descendant? All I do as a hunter is go out, patrol a place, and slay some monster. And I'd respond to some emergencies. At times, I'm too late to save the victim. Everything I do isn't enough!"

Glimmer stood, then approached Adora and reached out her hands to touch the blonde's face. Her thumbs caressed Adora's cheeks, wiping away the tears as the taller woman sobbed. Then, something came over her. More like an urge. Without thinking, she wrapped her arms around Adora's neck, pulling her closer. Fingers laced through the blonde's ponytail as their mouths met. She had never kissed anyone, and this was the first time she did. The scent of sandalwood shampoo wafted into her nostrils, and she could taste the vanilla chapstick. *Gosh, her lips are so soft.* Warmth overwhelmed her body, and the world became still. She didn't regret this, not even for a small second. Breaking away, she gazed into Adora's surprised eyes.

"Adora... you are enough," Glimmer said. "Just because something happens beyond your control, it doesn't make it your fault."

"G-Glim..." Adora choked out, sniffling.

"No matter what happens, I'll always be here for you." Glimmer replayed the kiss in her mind. "Did I startle you, though?"

"You didn't startle me. We did take it slow, after all."

"I've had a crush on you for a while."

"I've noticed a few signs." A blush colored Adora's cheeks. "Being touchy-feely, giving me those looks, and comforting me. Whenever I'm in danger, you were ready to protect me. One time, you came for me when I was in Fright Zone City. You're kind and loyal."

"So, anyways, did you enjoy the kiss?"

"Yes. Unexpected, but still enjoyable."

Glimmer smiled. "Do you want to do it again?"

Adora wrapped her arms around Glimmer's waist. "Of course."

The two women locked their lips in a passionate kiss. Glimmer pressed her hands into Adora's shoulder blades, her heart fluttering as she leaned into the blonde's embrace. She couldn't get enough of this wonderful feeling. Their faces parted, leaving room for them to breathe.

"I love you," Glimmer said.

"Love you too," Adora replied.

---

Night surrounded the city. Adora walked to the porch and sat on an antique bench, observing the street. Her hair was still damp

from taking a shower, and despite the warmth of her pajamas, the cool air snaked into her sleeves. She couldn't stop thinking about the kiss. It was gentle, unlike Catra's rough kisses. Still feeling the warmth of Glimmer's lips against hers, she rubbed her bottom lip with an index finger. The sound of an approaching car drew her attention. At first, she assumed the driver was a neighbor, but the streetlamp exposed a familiar vehicle. *Shadow Weaver's old car.* She retreated into the house and grabbed her dagger.

By the time Adora returned outside, her adoptive mother had already parked the car. She descended the porch steps, then pointed her dagger at the witch. "What are you doing here?"

"You're so defiant. But I won't let you stand in the way of Horde Prime's plan!" Shadow Weaver shouted as she approached.

Adora tossed the dagger at Shadow Weaver. "The Horde clan is not going to win!"

The dagger plunged into Shadow Weaver's abdomen. However, she didn't falter. Shadows sprung from the ground as she advanced. Her pale hands met Adora's face. "The Rebellion clan will not prevail." Her palms glowed with dark magic. "Hunters shall not stand in the way. You will perish."

Dark tendrils held Adora's body in place. "What are you going to do to me?"

Electricity enveloped Adora's head, then proceeded to the rest of her body. The only thing she could think of was her potential death. As soon as the witch's hands pulled away, she collapsed to the ground. As dark spots blurred her vision, a familiar voice, although distant, penetrated the silence. Every part of her wanted to move, to see what was going on, but she closed her eyes and lost consciousness.

---

Adora awakened in bed. A different one, with canopy curtains hanging on the frame. The light almost blinded her eyes as she

glanced around. How did she wind up in bed, let alone someone else's? Flashes of her confrontation with Shadow Weaver surfaced. She had tried to stop her adoptive mother with a dagger, but the witch knocked her out. And someone had yelled when she was losing consciousness. Glimmer's voice interrupted her thoughts.

"Adora, you're awake." Glimmer had been sitting in a nearby chair this whole time.

How did Adora not notice at first? She swung her legs over the edge of the bed. "Tell me what happened."

"I saw you outside the window, trying to fight off a witch. She used her magic on you, so I intervened."

"Did Shadow Weaver hurt you after I passed out?"

"No. I banished her."

Adora arched her brows. "You did? Where did she go?"

Glimmer shrugged. "Who knows? At least she'll leave you alone."

"And where's my dagger?"

"It's in your room."

"Good. I may need it to defeat Hordak and Horde Prime." Adora emitted an audible sigh. "I'll train first thing in the morning." She rose to her height. "I'm going to bed right now."

---

An hour after the two women exchanged their good-nights, Glimmer tossed and turned in bed as she pulled the covers over her body. Blurry images surfaced in her mind as she tried to fight off the nightmare. Her breaths came in short gasps, and sweat moistened her forehead. As much as she wanted to wake up from the nightmare, she couldn't. This one was vivid, and a part of her wondered if it was a warning of things to come...

...

*Glimmer was racing through a cavern. Water dripped from the ceiling as she scrutinized the walls and arches. She was looking for something, but she had no idea what it was. Or why it seemed to hold so much importance to her. Then, she entered a room and saw Adora. The blonde had reclined on an altar, asleep. A dark silhouette, cloaked in smoke, held out a hand.*

*"You failed to save your precious girlfriend," a cruel voice said. "I'll destroy the hunter. She has proven to be a nuisance."*

*A pair of green eyes glowed menacingly as the disembodied hand brushed Adora's face. Glimmer wanted to beat up this person and get Adora out of here. Yet she was frozen to the spot. Tears streaming down her cheeks, she balled her hands into fists. The disembodied hand grabbed Adora's throat, its talons digging into her flesh. Adora's eyes fluttered open. At first, she struggled to break free, but the attacker was too strong. Then, she turned her attention to Glimmer.*

*"Glimmer, help-" Adora squeaked out.*

*"Don't hurt Adora!" Glimmer shouted. "Just stop!" Tears streamed down her cheeks.*

...

Glimmer sat up in bed, screaming. The scene remained fresh in her brain as she took in the outlines of the furniture. She recalled Adora saying something about Horde Prime killing Mara. If the person in her nightmare was him, would he try to murder her? The hunters were usually his targets. A thought flashed into her mind. Was Mara scared, too, when Horde Prime executed her? Lights flooded the room, and the door swung open, revealing Adora.

"Are you okay?" Adora asked as she stepped closer and sat on the bed.

"I had a nightmare. Horde Prime was hurting you, and I couldn't save you," Glimmer said.

"I'm here, and I'm still alive." Adora pulled Glimmer into an embrace. "The nightmare won't become a reality. You'd be quick to protect me. Can I stay in here to protect you from nightmares?"

"Sure. I want you nearby anyways."

Chapter End Notes

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Tumblr: @thatadorablewarriorlady

# Chapter 13

Chapter Notes

> Thought this chapter would be short, but it winded up being longer than Ch. 12. Enjoy. This is the last chapter.

After breakfast, Adora and Glimmer received a report of unusual supernatural activity in the cemetery. They proceeded to visit the cemetery, and as soon as they arrived, they entered the catacombs. While Adora was equipped with other items other than her dagger, Glimmer carried several potions in her bag. Navigating the catacombs, they checked every room and passageway. At one point, they decided to check the room where they left Catra. What they saw shocked them. Somehow Catra escaped the chains.

"How did this happen?" Glimmer asked. "I thought the wolfsbane potion was strong enough to prevent a transformation for a day or so."

"Someone must have aided her," Adora said. "Let's keep looking. Can we split up? It'll make the search go faster."

Glimmer shook her head. "I'd rather keep you safe."

"I can take care of myself."

"Are you sure?"

Adora nodded. "I have the dagger, and I've defended myself a few times."

"Okay," Glimmer said as the two women parted ways.

Adora stepped into a dark hallway. Turning on her flashlight, she made her way to a flight of stairs. Descending the stairs, she sensed the temperature dropping. By the time she reached the bottom of the steps, a portal formed. *Just like the one in my dream.* Her stomach clenched. Should she call Glimmer? She

didn't want to sound like a scared damsel who needed saving, so she pushed aside the idea of alerting the shorter woman. As she approached the portal, a growl drilled into her ears. Should she go ahead and enter by herself? Heart pounding in her chest, she swallowed her dread, and...

"Adora, wait!" Glimmer shouted as she approached the blonde.

"Let me guess. Location spell," Adora said.

"For starters, I had a bad feeling about this."

"At least we both found what we're looking for."

Glimmer's eyes widened. "Adora, look behind you!"

Adora whirled around in time to see a demonic hand emerging from the portal. It grabbed her shirt, then yanked her into the portal. Squeezing her eyes shut, she anticipated a fatal outcome. The hand released its grip and dropped her onto something hard. Pain flooded her skull as she opened her eyes. She found herself in a cavern. Where was she? She observed her surroundings. Was Glimmer still in the catacombs? She forced herself up. In front of her stood a throne. A tall, broad-shouldered man with pale skin and sickly green eyes loomed over her.

"At long last, we have met. I have encountered a hunter similar to you," the man said. "I'm Horde Prime."

"I'll stop you," Adora said.

"You're so bold." Horde Prime wore a sinister grin. "You ran into one of my minions, did you not? Hordak is no longer useful to me. I executed him. This ends now, little hunter. The Horde clan shall suppress the human race." He snapped his fingers, and a roar echoed off the walls. "According to your old friend's report, a girl is trying to help you win."

"What old friend? Catra?"

"Catra works for me. I won't kill you right now, as I'm waiting for your companion to walk into a trap. My pet will slow you down."

As if on cue, a tentacle-like beast emerged from the shadows. It swung a thick, scaly tendril toward Adora, leaving no time for her to evade the attack. She flew into a wall, then slid to the floor, moaning in pain. Horde Prime cackled at her misery. *Am I going to die, too?* The wicked demon made his way out of the throne room, leaving her alone with the monster. She clutched her side, staring at the beast.

"Adora? Where are you?" A familiar voice called out.

Adora grabbed one of the tentacles and plunged her dagger into the limb. The beast roared as it wrapped a tendril around her legs. Before she could do anything, the tendril lifted her off the ground. The same voice repeated her name. This time, the speaker was closer. Glimmer stood in the archway, belting out an incantation. As the witch completed the chant, she chucked a potion forward.

The tentacle lost its grip on Adora. As she fell to the ground, the shorter woman began levitating her. Relief flooded her heart as she felt an invisible force carrying her downward, allowing her to land onto her feet. Agony overwhelmed her body. Was it an effect of the monster attacking her? As she glanced over her shoulder, she noticed that the monster was gone. Her legs gave out under her. Was this what Horde Prime meant when he said that the large creature would slow her down?

Glimmer helped Adora up. "How bad is the pain?"

"What do you think?" Adora replied. "Horde Prime's 'pet' weakened me. I can feel it in my body."

"Shit." Glimmer led Adora toward the wall and leaned her against the barrier. She rummaged through her bag, vials clinking against each other as she continued her frantic search. "Oh, no."

Adora's heart dropped. "Don't you know a healing spell?"

"I left the potion at home. I'll try a healing spell."

"Okay."

Glimmer held Adora's hands and whispered an incantation. She repeated herself over and over.

Adora's eyelids grew heavy. She fought the urge to fall asleep and let herself die. Whatever the spell was, it didn't seem to be working. She was here to eliminate Horde Prime, not lose her life in this place.

"I'll find Horde Prime. I don't know why the spell doesn't work," Glimmer said.

---

Glimmer led Adora through the tunnels, searching for Horde Prime while keeping the demons at bay. Each time Adora exhaled, she thought it would be the blonde's last breath. The dream from last night wasn't accurate, but it still served as a warning. She couldn't lose Adora. Not when they had kissed yesterday. Would she be doomed to losing the people she cared about the most? *Get a grip. Adora needs you to be strong for her.* By the time the two women entered an empty room, she glanced at Adora.

"Adora? Are you in there?" Glimmer asked as she let Adora recline on the ground. She descended to her knees. "Please answer me."

---

A thick fog surrounded Adora. She knew she was somewhere between life and death. Her spirit hadn't left her body, but if nothing was done, she would pass away. A feminine silhouette stepped forward. As the identity became clear, she gasped. *Mara?*

"I saw you infiltrating Horde Prime's lair," Mara said. "Do not fear. You are not dead. At least, not entirely. Your love has found you in time."

"My love?" Adora asked. Then, it clicked in her mind. "Oh. You mean Glimmer."

"Hold on to your life." Mara wore a serene expression. "What is it you truly want?"

Adora hesitated. "To stop Horde Prime?"

"I am referring to your deepest desire. When I was alive, I wanted to run away with Serenia and have a happy life with her. Instead, I sacrificed myself. Don't you want to have a full life? Especially with your love?"

Thoughts of Glimmer flashed through Adora's mind. "Yes. Is my time coming, though?"

"Not yet," Mara said. "I believe you will be the one who defeats Horde Prime once and for all."

"Okay. I'll return to my earthly life. One question- where are you?"

"I've moved on from my past life. I don't think Serenia has. Just go back to the land of the living."

---

Glimmer's tears fell onto Adora's face as her frame shook with sobs. She planted a tearful kiss on the blonde's lips. As soon as she broke away, Adora's eyes opened. The woman's wounds vanished.

"Adora!" Glimmer exclaimed as she pulled Adora into an embrace.

"Glimmer, I'll be here longer," Adora said. "Alright, let's stop Horde Prime."

As the two women rose from the ground, footsteps approached. Glimmer stood in front of Adora. She almost lost Adora, and she wouldn't risk losing her friend again. Catra accompanied a tall man. *This dude must be Horde Prime.*

"I thought she was dead. Turns out I was wrong," the man said.

"Horde Prime," Adora said as she moved past Glimmer. "You're toast. Catra, what are you doing here?"

Catra smirked. "I can do whatever I want."

"You're working with him now?"

"You'll see." Catra transformed into a werepanther and lunged at Horde Prime.

Horde Prime unleashed an electrical sphere at her, electrocuting her. The werepanther roared in pain, collapsing to her side as Adora lunged at Prime. They began exchanging blows. Uppercuts, kicks, punches, and backhands. The demon was swift on his feet, predicting each of her moves and parrying her. Just as she drew her dagger, he grabbed her wrist and tightened his hold. Wincing in pain, she swung her free hand at his face and connected. Prime launched his hand at her throat and began choking her.

"Don't hurt her!" Glimmer bellowed as she unleashed her magic at Prime, forcing him to release Adora.

The demon flew across the room and landed onto his back. Catra pounced on him, then clawed his chest. It didn't take long for him to force her off. While Adora tossed her dagger, Glimmer chucked a potion. Horde Prime ducked both items and charged at the duo.

"I'll destroy you!" Horde Prime shouted.

Glimmer levitated the dagger to Adora. "Let's get him."

Adora snatched the dagger and waited for Horde Prime to come closer. She plunged the blade into his chest, making him scream in agony. Glimmer tossed another potion and spoke an incantation. Horde Prime screamed as he vanished into thin air.

"We won," Adora said.

Catra transformed into her regular form. "Hordak let me escape the catacombs earlier, only to bring me here. Since I helped fight

Horde Prime-"

Glimmer glowered at Catra. "Don't expect us to forgive you. All you could do was offer a proper apology. And you didn't. What the fuck did you expect in return?"

"I get it. I've been a shitty person."

"Take responsibility for your actions and be kind for once."

Adora cleared her throat. "Glimmer, let's go home."

---

The following day, Adora and Glimmer hosted a small gathering at their house in celebration of their victory. They ordered pizza, and their friends got a slice or two. Catra hadn't shown up, as they didn't consider her a friend. The werepanther did leave a text message, saying that she would go to therapy and work on her attitude. Today, Adora wore a red blazer with a white t-shirt underneath. Her slacks matched her t-shirt. Glimmer wore a deep purple dress.

Everyone gathered in the living room to talk. Glimmer said, "The Horde clan lost."

"It means no more demons and other dark creatures, right?" Adam asked.

"Right," Adora said. "How's Teela?"

"She's getting better. Maybe tonight or tomorrow, she'll be out of the hospital."

Bow rose his hand. "Can I announce something?"

Glimmer arched her brows. "What is it?"

"Perfuma and I are engaged."

"Wow, congratulations. Anyways, Adora and I may go steady."

Perfuma gasped. "Did you two kiss yet?"

Adora nodded. "We did."

Mermista sipped her drink. "Good luck on your relationship."

Sea Hawk rose to his height. "Can I make up a song about the victory?"

"Sea Hawk, save the shanties for later!"

"Aww..." Sea Hawk flashed a puppy-eyes look.

"Not gonna work on me," Mermista said.

Glimmer and Adora walked to the kitchen. The two women gazed into each other's eyes, refusing to break eye contact. Adora's fingers intertwined with Glimmer's. Silence fell between them, and their world halted. Their faces inched closer, breaths mingling as the blonde drew her true love into an embrace. Adora cupped Glimmer's face with both hands. Lips locking, they lost themselves in the moment. Then, she pulled away.

"Were you aware of me kissing you when you were on the brink of death?" Glimmer asked. "I think it saved your life. You know, Sleeping Beauty style. But darker."

"It wasn't my time, so I came back to life," Adora said.

Footsteps entered the kitchen. Serenia and Mara lingered by the counter. Had Mara's spirit followed Adora and Glimmer here?

Serenia wore a smile. "Thanks to you, Mara and I are together again."

"Adora, you did so well, defeating Horde Prime," Mara said.

Adora grinned. "I'm glad the two of you are together again. Be at peace."

The spirits vanished. Adora turned her attention to Glimmer. "Looks like they're happy now."

"So are we," Glimmer said. "Adora... will you be my girlfriend?"

Adora smooched Glimmer's lips. "Yes."

They were meant to be. A long time ago, Adora had assumed that Catra was the one, but the werepanther had hurt her. Glimmer had proven to be different. Special, even. She had learned that love wasn't supposed to be painful. Glimmer was the one for her. And she knew it in her heart.

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